adrian zhang

memories

for harp, piano, vibraphone, flute, and cello

(2024)

Instrumentation:

Piano
Harp
Flute
Vibraphone
Violoncello

Performance Notes:

For All Instruments:

l.v. = let vibrate
ord. = ordinary playing
ad lib. = play a passage without preparation, improvise.
[technique] ad lib. = employ a certain technique, but the pitch register, pitches themselves, etc. are improvised.

 = short fermata

 = medium fermata

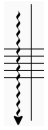
 = long fermata

 = quarter-tone higher

 = quarter-tone lower

For Piano:
The lid must remain open, for there are techniques that involve the strings of the piano.

pizz. = pluck the string of the piano.

 = glissando down the strings of the piano. The register of the glissando is generally ad libitum, but within the restraints of what is graphically shown.
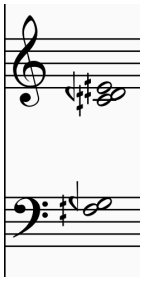
For Harp:

º = harmonics

 = rub with the fingertip along the string of the harp. This is done vertically on a singular wire string, and generally ends with downward

motion. This cannot be done too fast or too slow. It produces a sound similar to a swish on the chinese guqin.

The harp will be playing microtones, and thus should be tuned as follows before the performance:



For Flute:

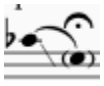
Due to the variety of sounds the flute employs in this piece, instructions for specific techniques or types of sound are indicated on the score in word format. However, special noteheads or symbols still apply in order to differentiate.

flz. = flatterzunge/flutter-tongue

 = indicates a note with no pitch. This can be key clicks or an airy tone.

 = indicates a note that has pitch, but is airy. This is different from normal playing.

 = indicates a jet whistle. Pitch is not specified.

 = indicates a pitch bend. This is a smooth glissando from note to note, with no audible separation in half-tones.

Some passages require playing of multiphonics. Because there is no designated performer and thus no designated flute model, the fingering charts are omitted.

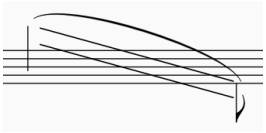
For Cello:

s.p. = sul ponticello

pizz. with gliss. = when employing pizzicato, move the left hand from the desired starting pitch to the ending pitch.

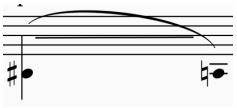
 = indicates use of harmonics. Hover slightly over the note with the diamond notehead.

 = increase bow pressure, until the sound is rough and jagged

 = create “seagull effect.” By utilizing harmonics and glissando at the same time, a sound that is reminiscent of a seagull is produced. No defined pitch.

 = slap the strings that are indicated with the bowing hand.

For Vibraphone:
In order to play the chords in this piece without needing to roll or separate them, the player should utilize a 4-mallet grip.

 = indicates a pitch bend. The player must play on a bar, and using a separate hard mallet, press and drag across the bar.

This piece is notated proportionally, and thus there is no set duration. The succession of instruments in a given passage should be interpreted graphically. Certain lines indicate succession and unison:

For succession, a dotted () line is used, and

for unison, a dashed ( ) line is used. Thick lines ( ) indicate continuation.

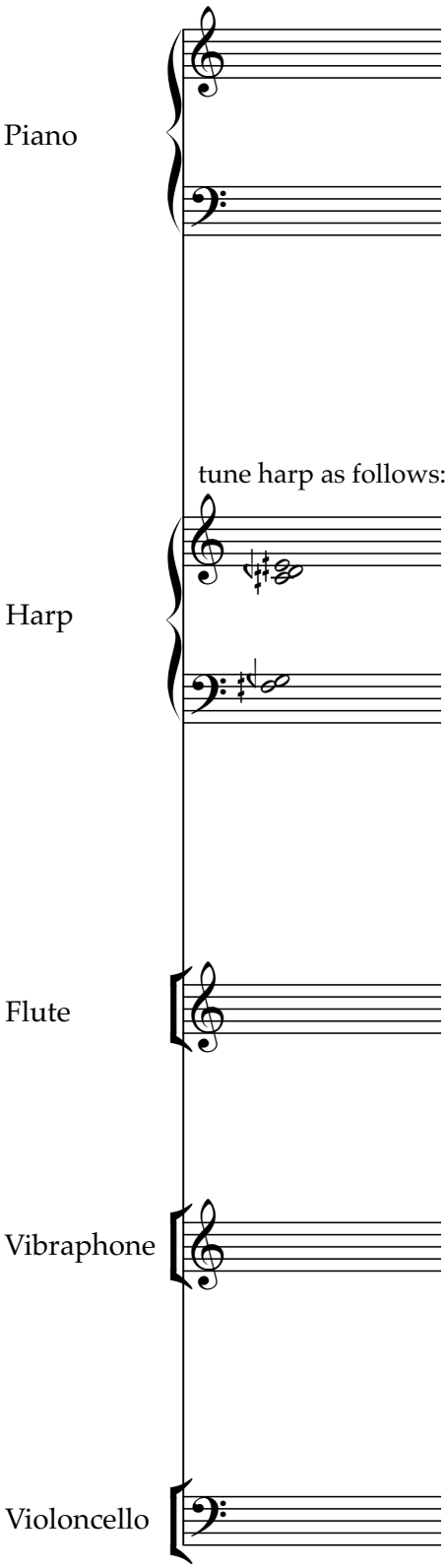
This piece involves passages where the performer improvises. Thus, performers should be prepared for such passages. Lines indicate a rough guideline of what notes performers should play, but it is best not to follow them precisely.
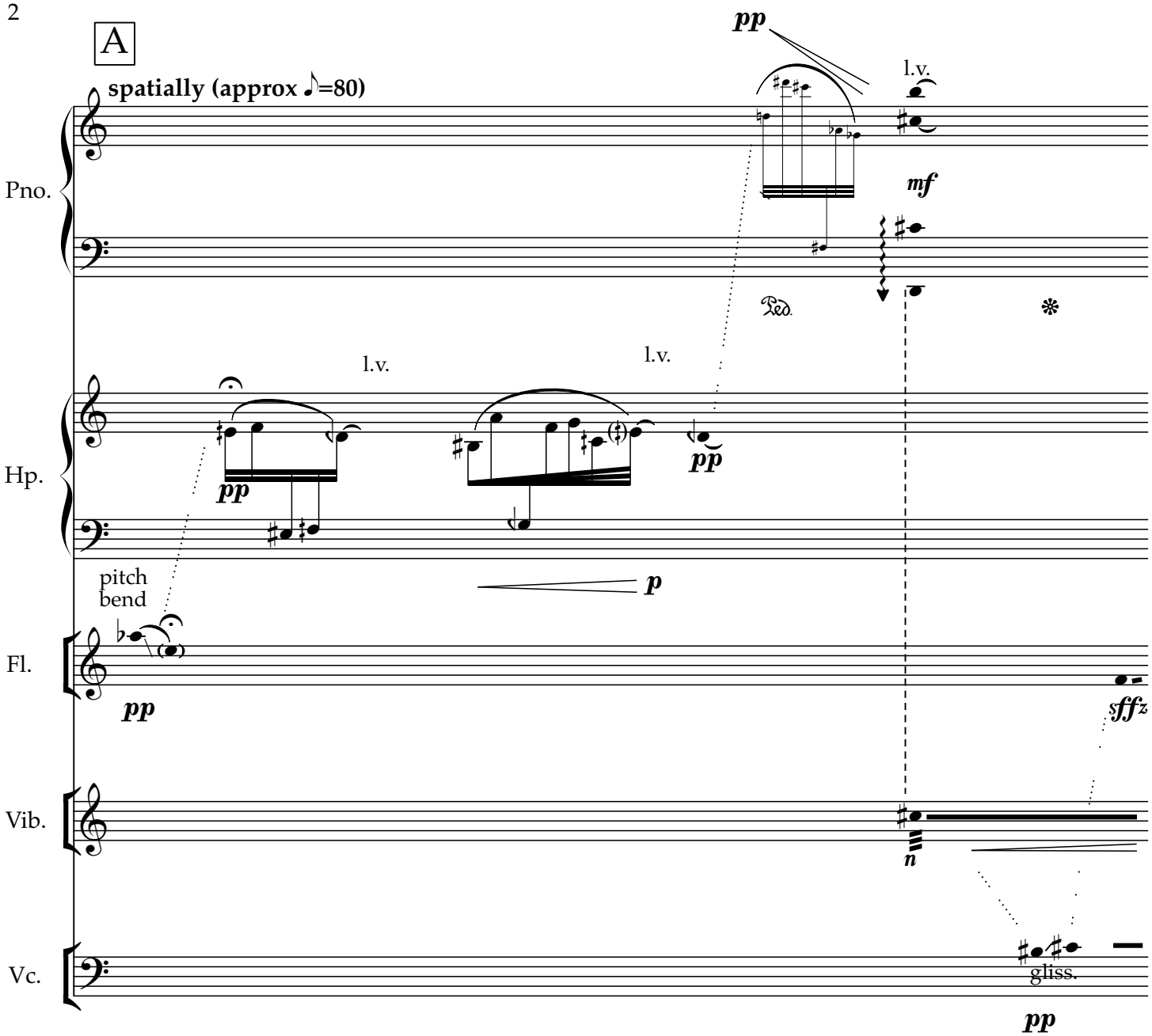
Memories

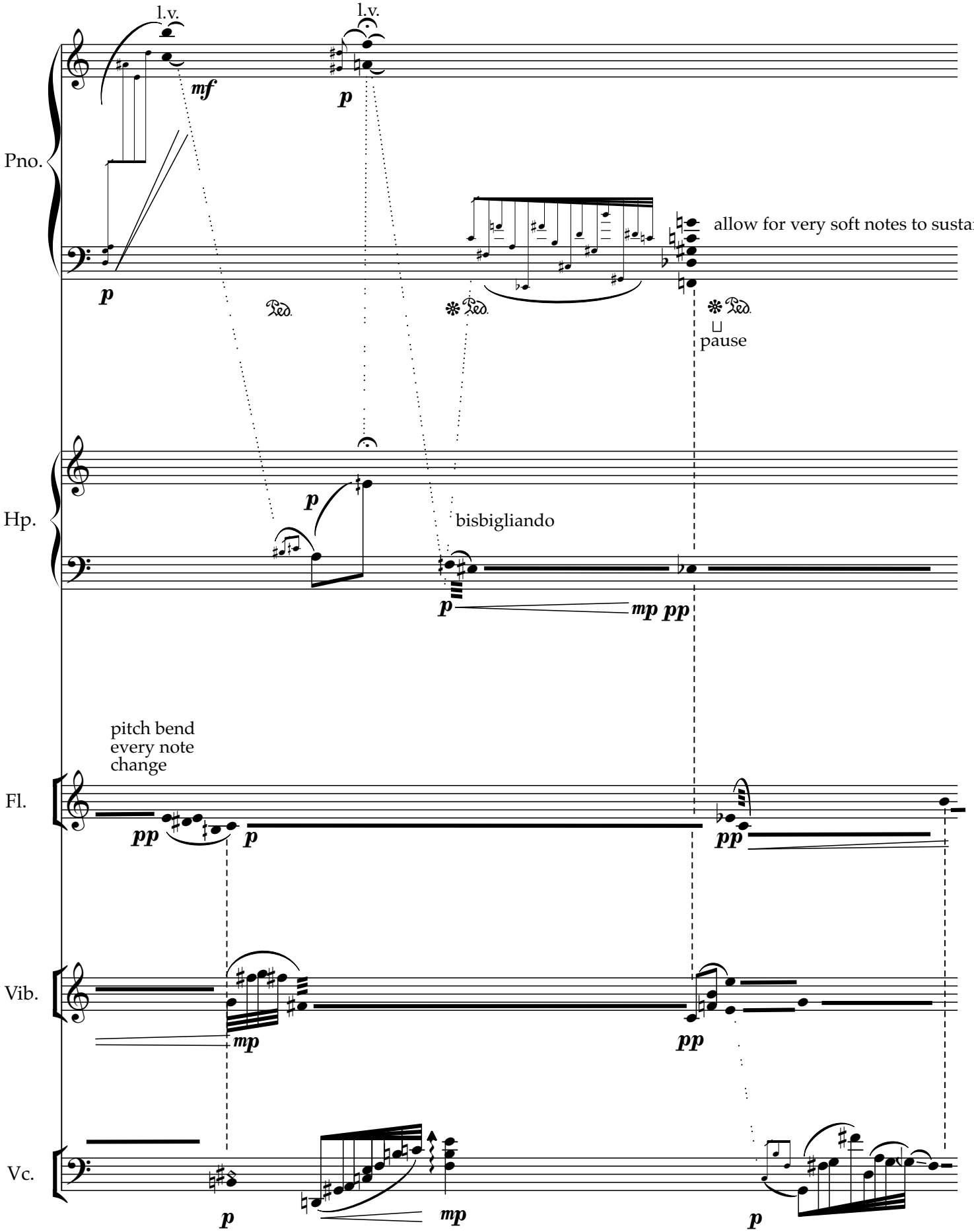
What are memories?
Whether vivid or opaque, gripping or distant, our memories emerge as fragmented constellations of our lived experiences.
When we encounter a sight or sound that feels vaguely familiar, we are likely sensing the resonating echo from an obscure memory just beyond our conscious reach.
To some extent, our memories are the judgment we pass in relation to our past encounters and choices—or at least our perception of what we experienced and decided.
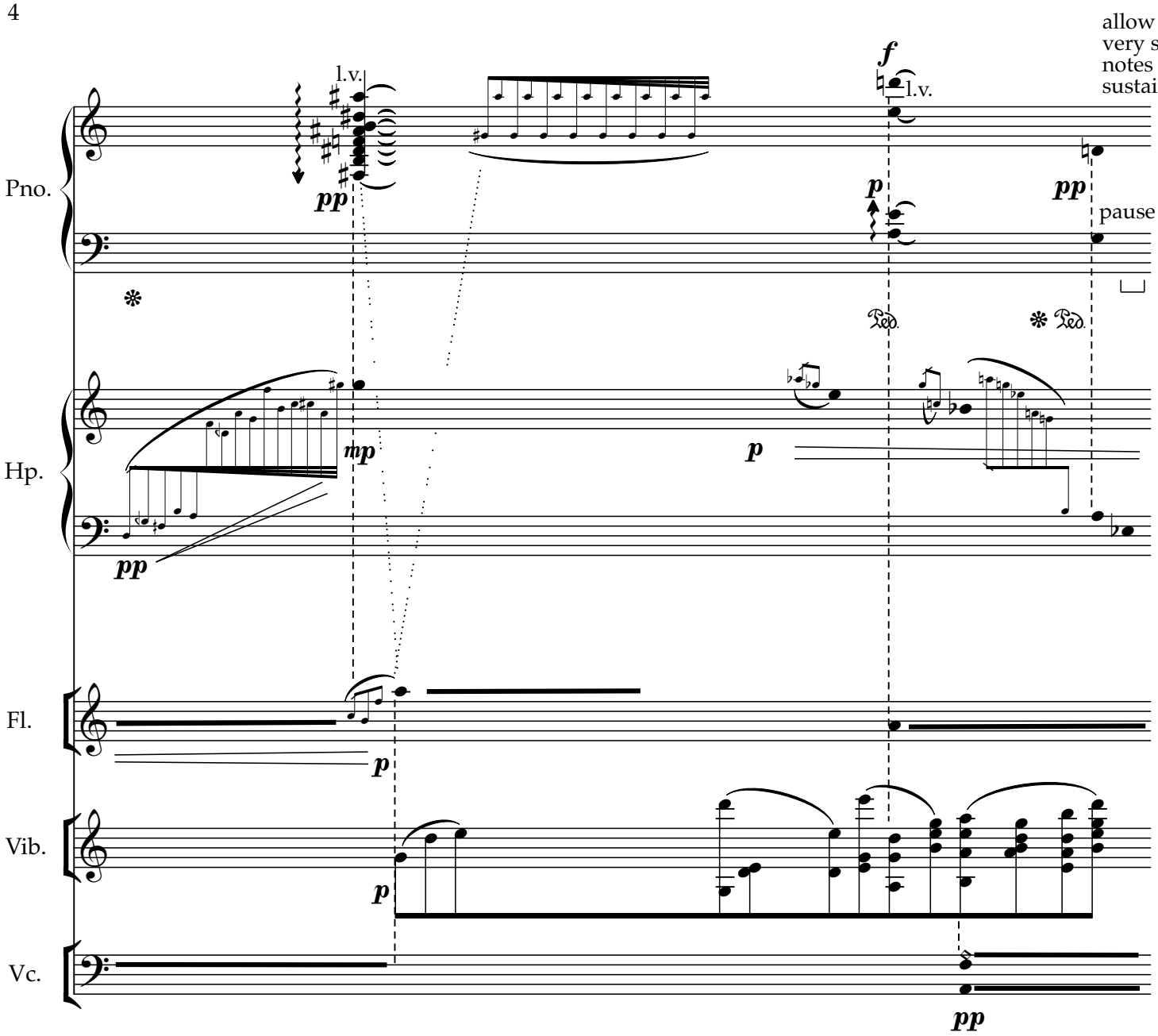
While many neuroscientists and psychologists have devoted considerable scientific attention to memory, I have decided to explore this fascinating topic through a musical lens.
Therefore, a majority of "Memories" consists of sound fragments—short or long, played once or repeated, a quick series of notes or one resonating sound, part of a chord or standing alone—a fluctuating structure that reflects the indeterminate nature of memories. Consequently, "Memories" is notated proportionally, not conforming to a certain length or duration. Some parts are left to the performer's interpretation, with each musician potentially perceiving the same material differently. This is because our memories are subjective recollections of events that have perhaps been altered by our personal point-of-views, biases, or selective (in)attention—with the meaning and significance of the experience completely up to the beholder.

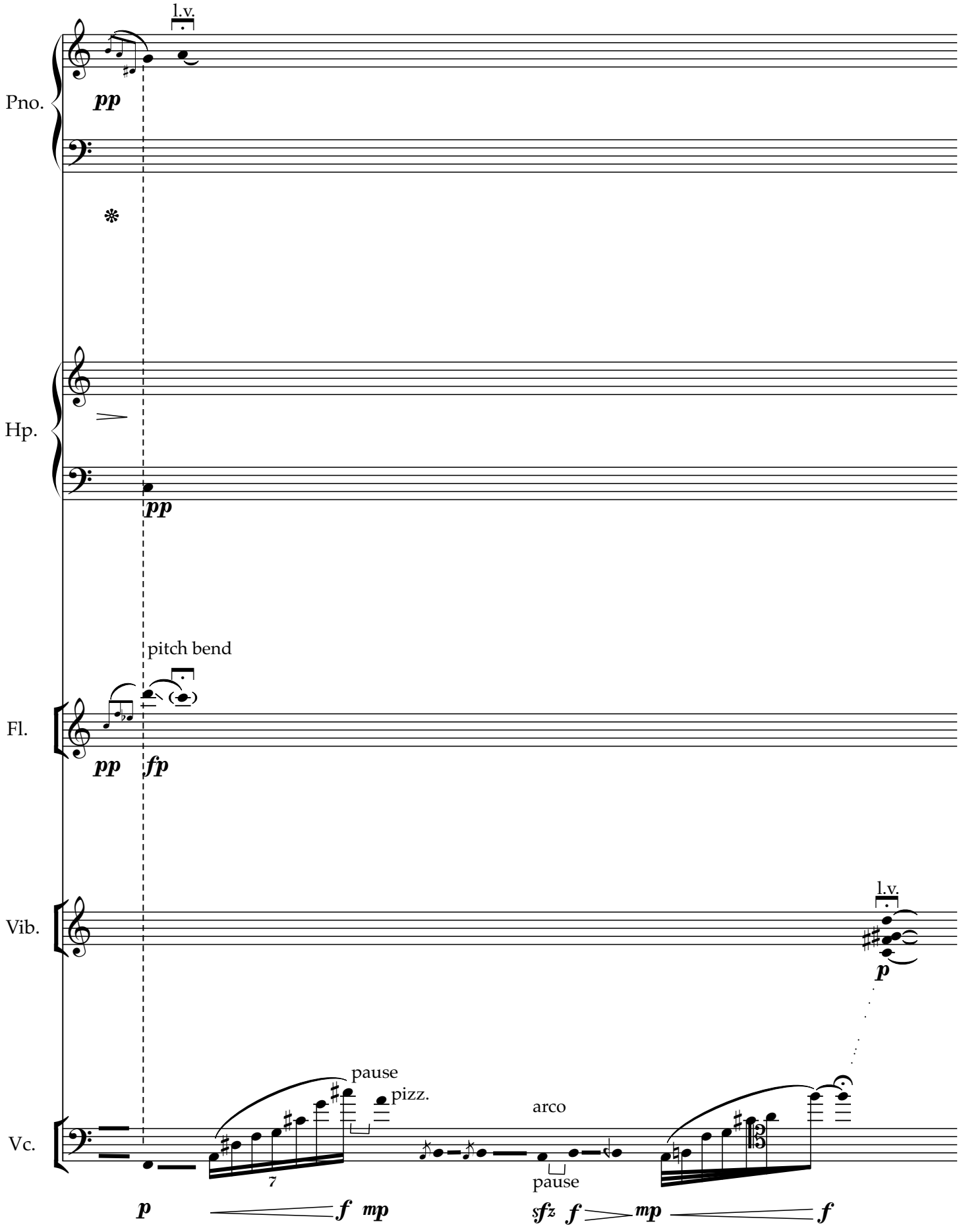
Memories

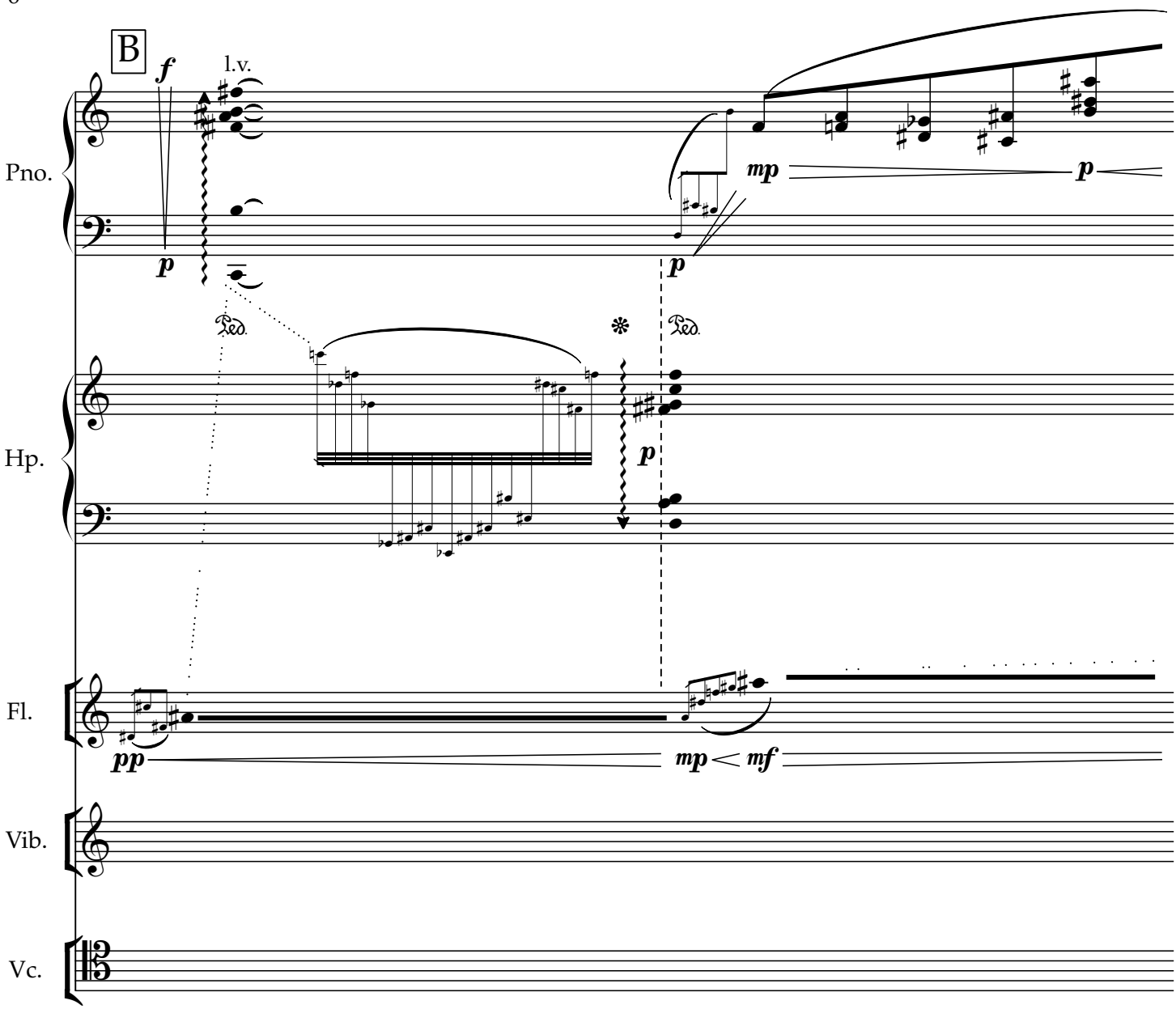

Piano
tune harp as follows:
Harp
Flute
Vibraphone
Violoncello

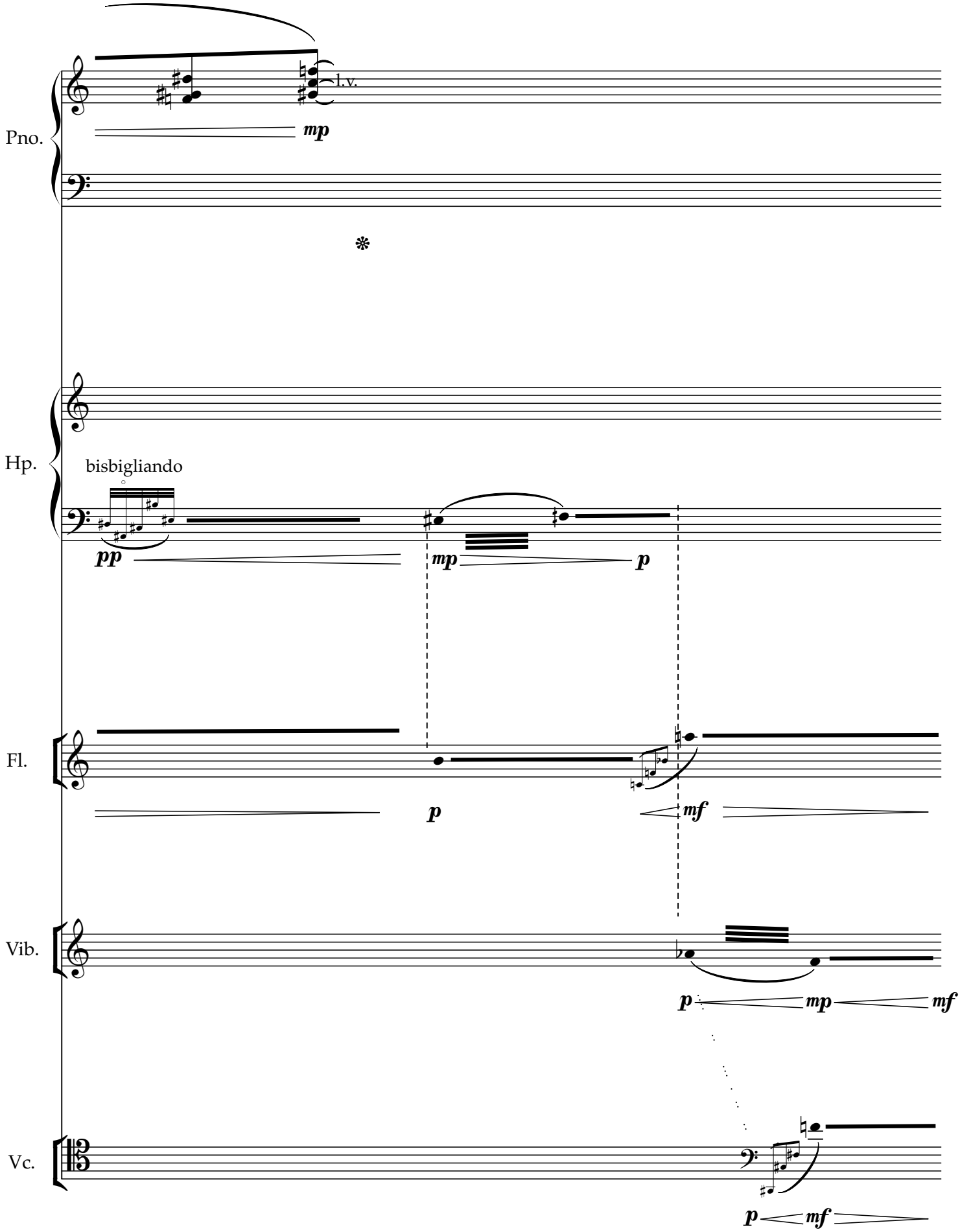

A
spatially (approx ♪=80)
pp
l.v.
mf
Pno.
Ped.
l.v.
l.v.
pp
pp
Hp.
p
pitch bend
Fl.
pp
sffz
Vib.
n
Vc.
gliss.
pp

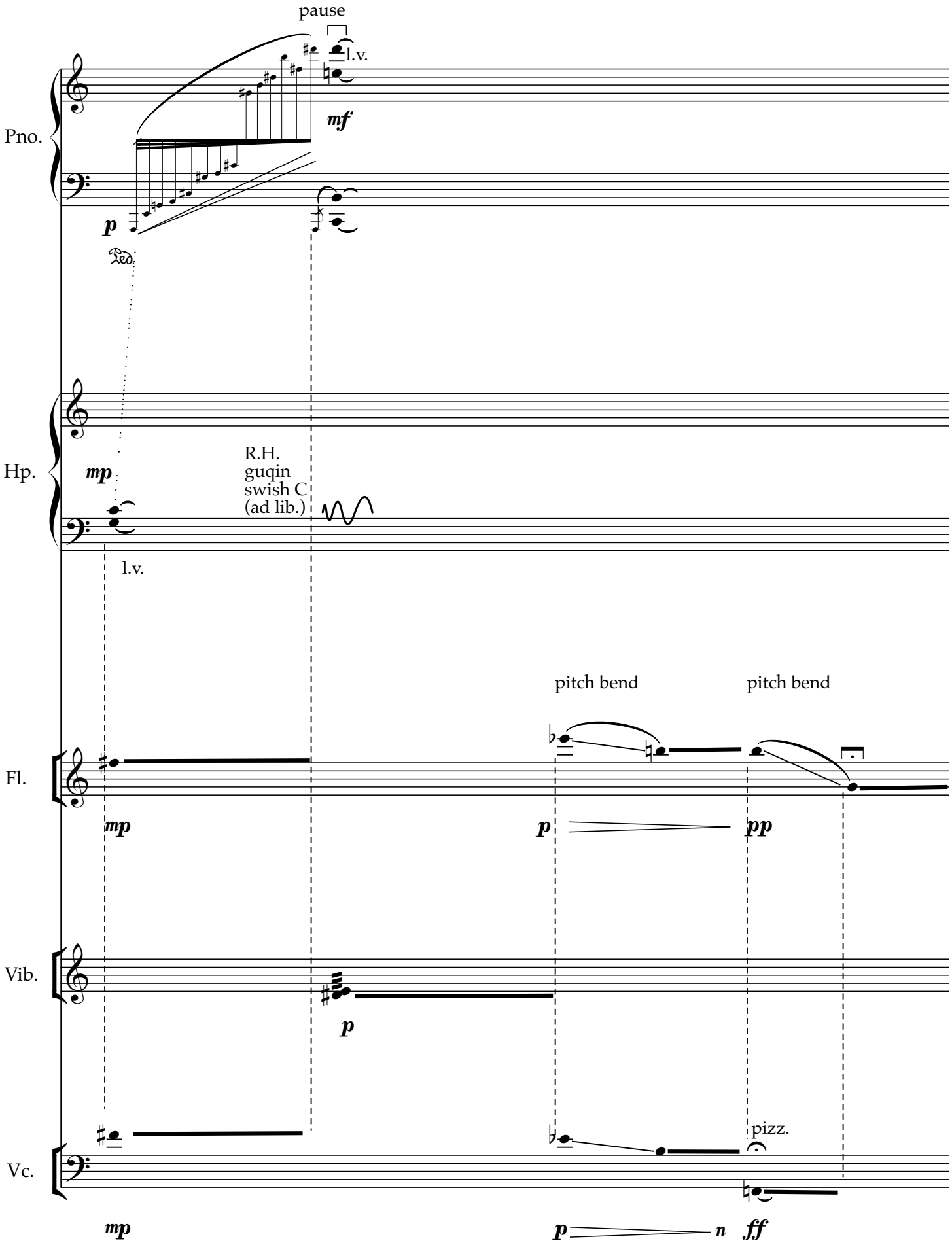

l.v.
l.v.
Pno.
mf
p
p
allow for very soft notes to sustain
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
pause
Hp.
p
bisbigliando
p
mp pp
pitch bend
every note
change
Fl.
pp
p
pp
Vib.
mp
pp
Vc.
p
mp
p

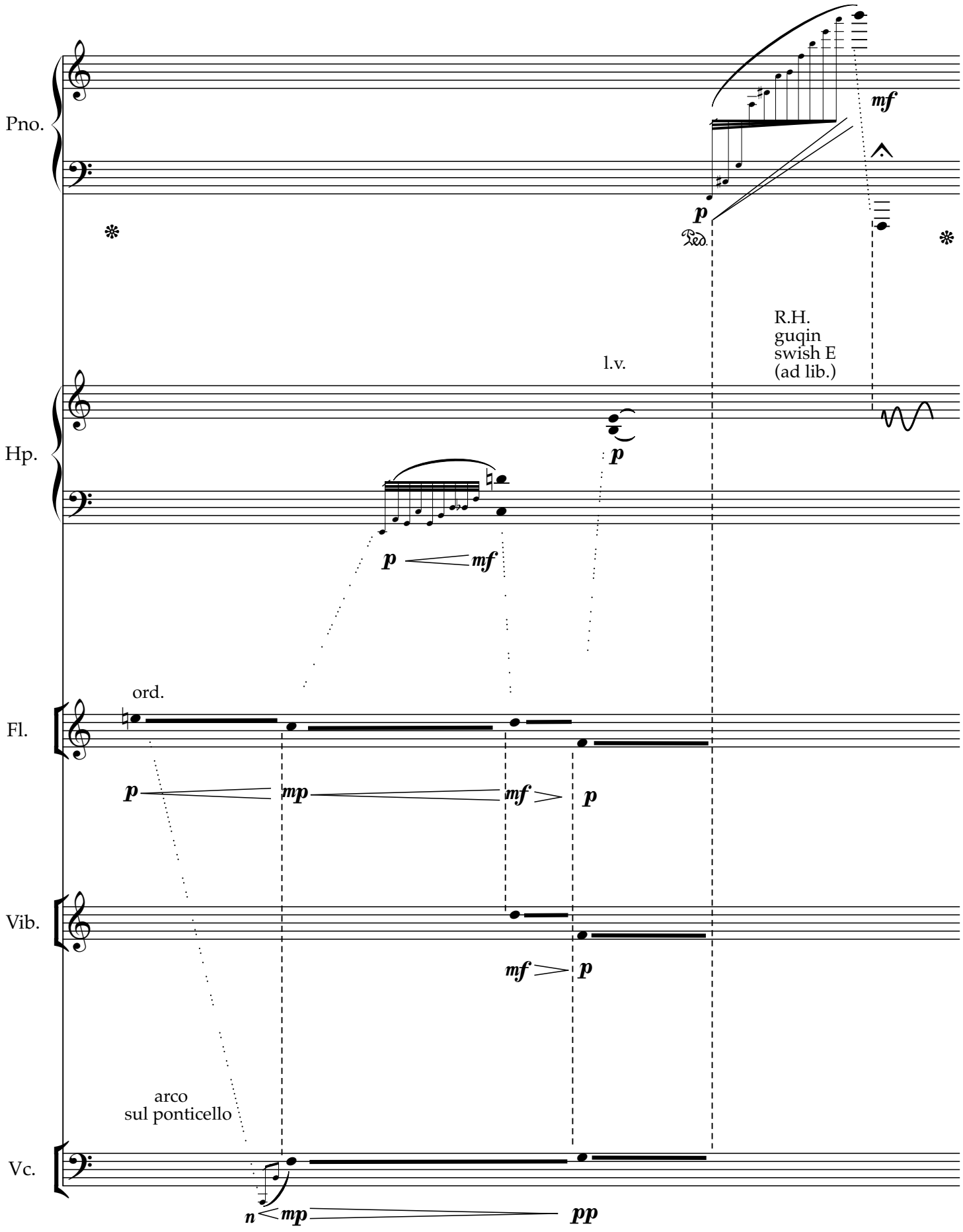

allow for very soft notes to sustain
Pno.
l.v.
pp
f
l.v.
p
pp
pause
Ped.
Ped.
Hp.
mp
p
pp
Fl.
p
Vib.
p
Vc.
pp
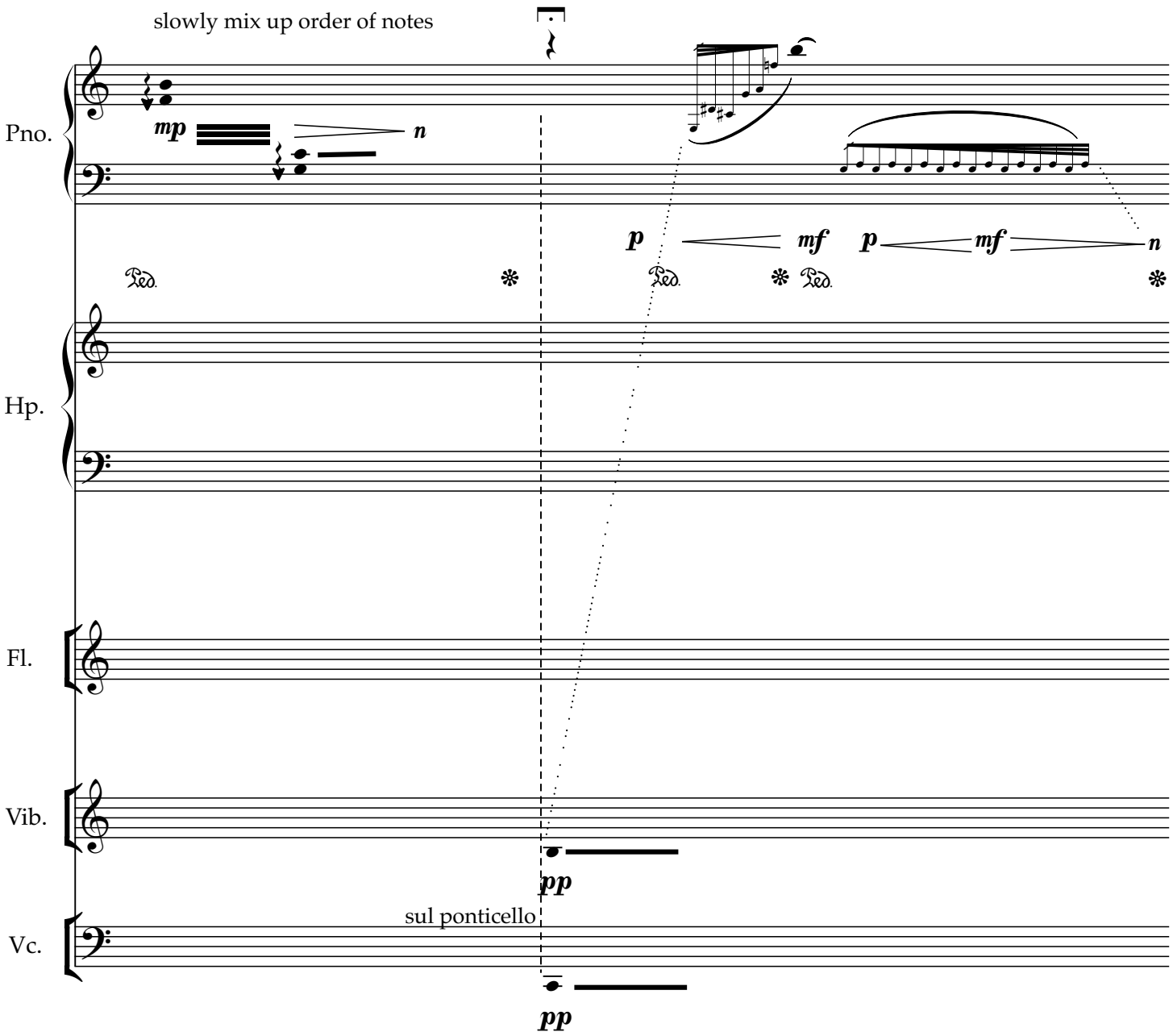

l.v.
Pno.
pp
Hp.
pp
pitch bend
Fl.
pp
fp
Vib.
l.v.
p
Vc.
pause
pizz.
arco
pause
p
f
mp
sfz
f
mp
f

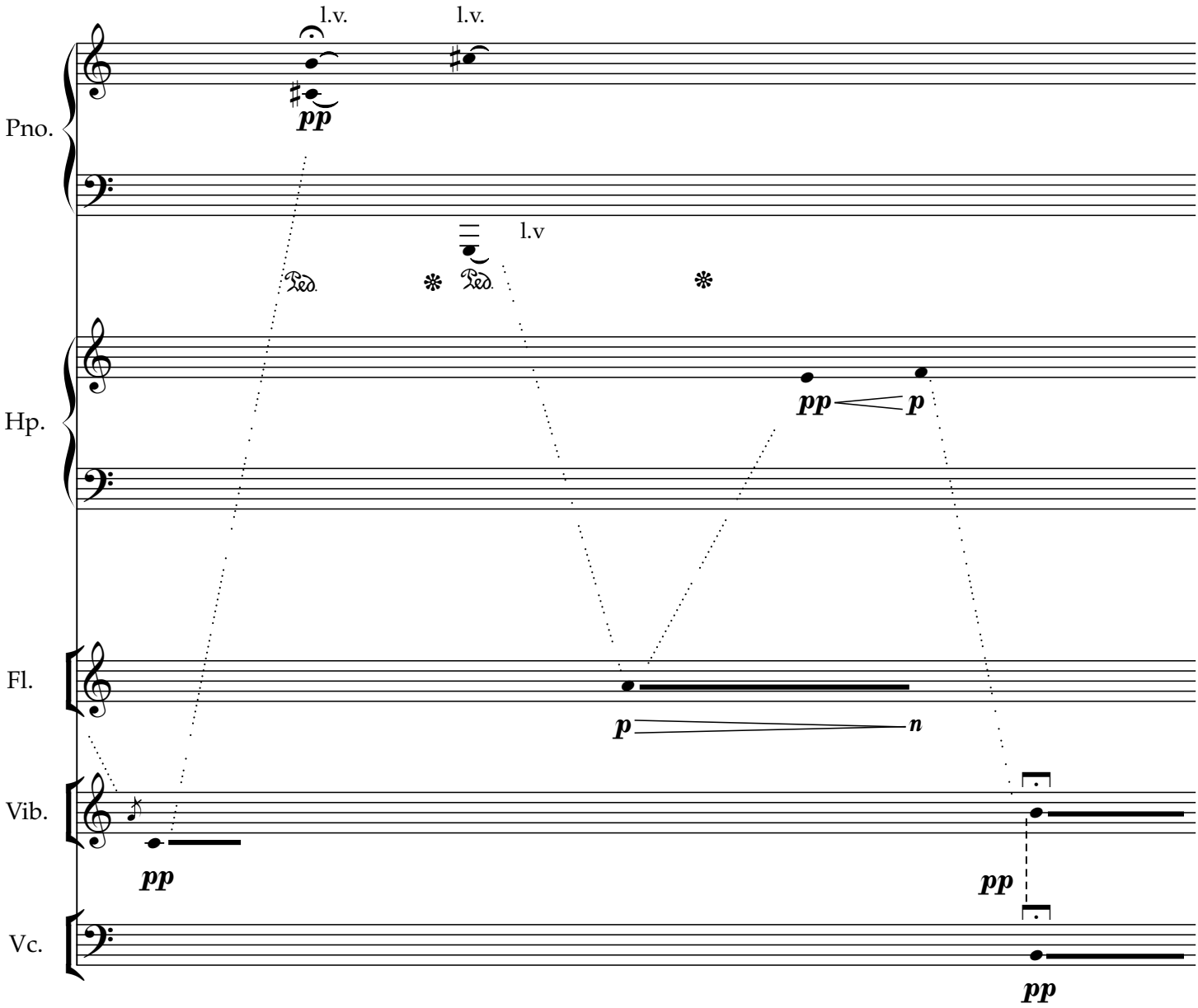

B
f
l.v.
Pno.
p
mp
p
p
Ped.
Ped.
Hp.
p
Fl.
pp
mp
mf
Vib.
Vc.

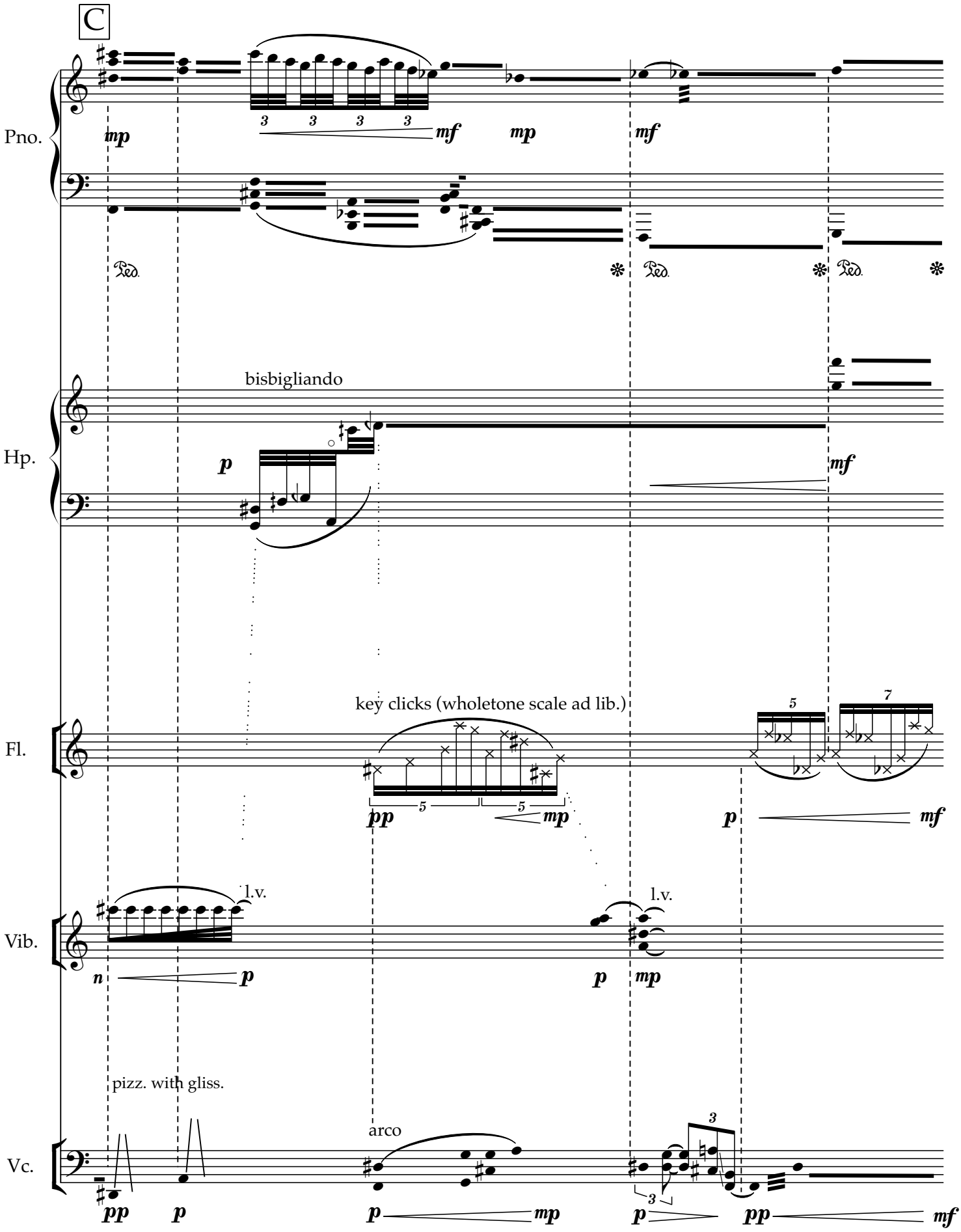

Pno.
l.v.
mp
Hp.
bisbigliando
pp
mp
p
Fl.
p
mf
Vib.
p
mp
mf
Vc.
p
mf
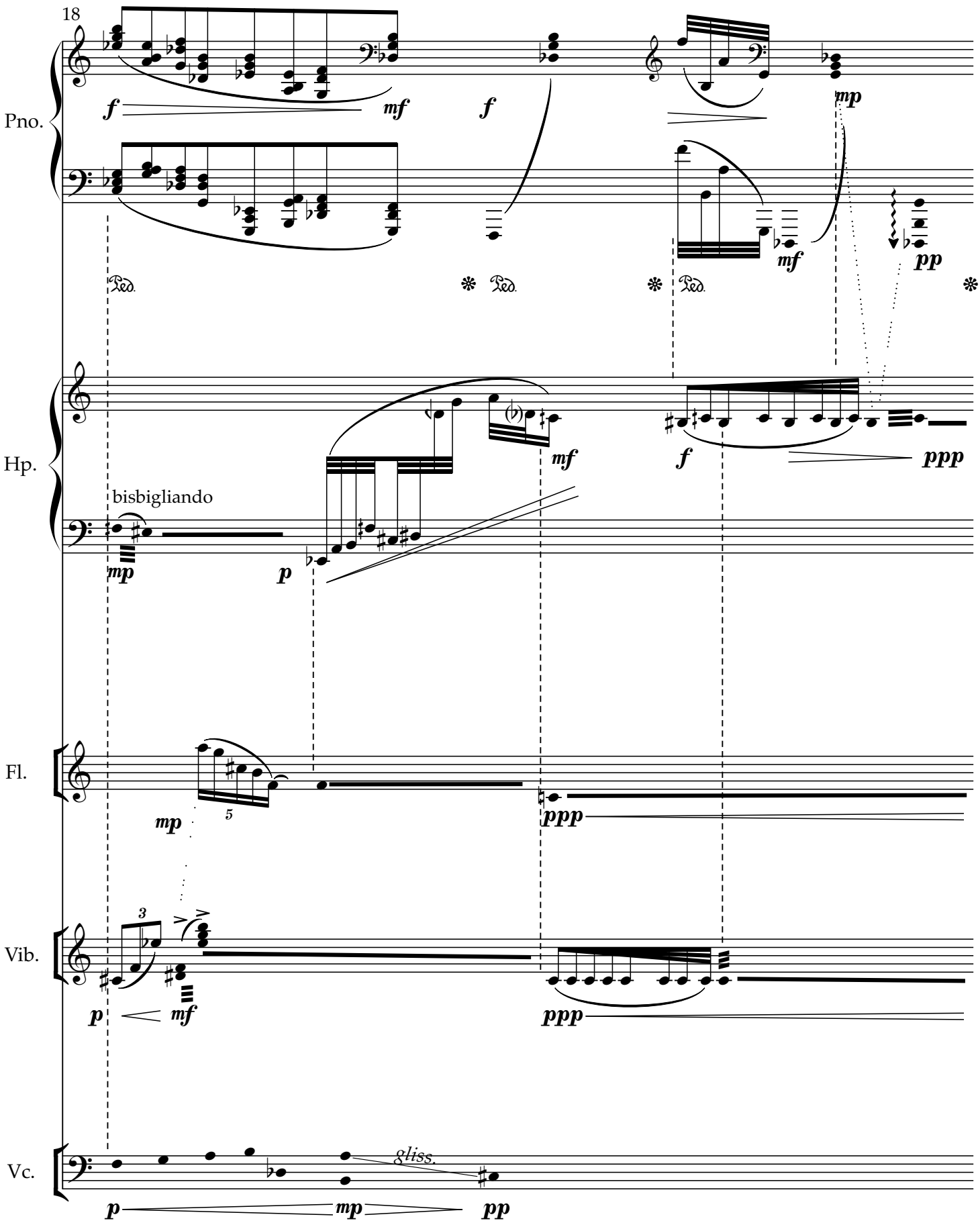

pause
l.v.
Pno.
mf
p
Ped.
Hp.
mp
R.H.
guqin
swish C
(ad lib.)
l.v.
pitch bend
pitch bend
Fl.
mp
p
pp
Vib.
p
Vc.
pizz.
mp
p
n
ff
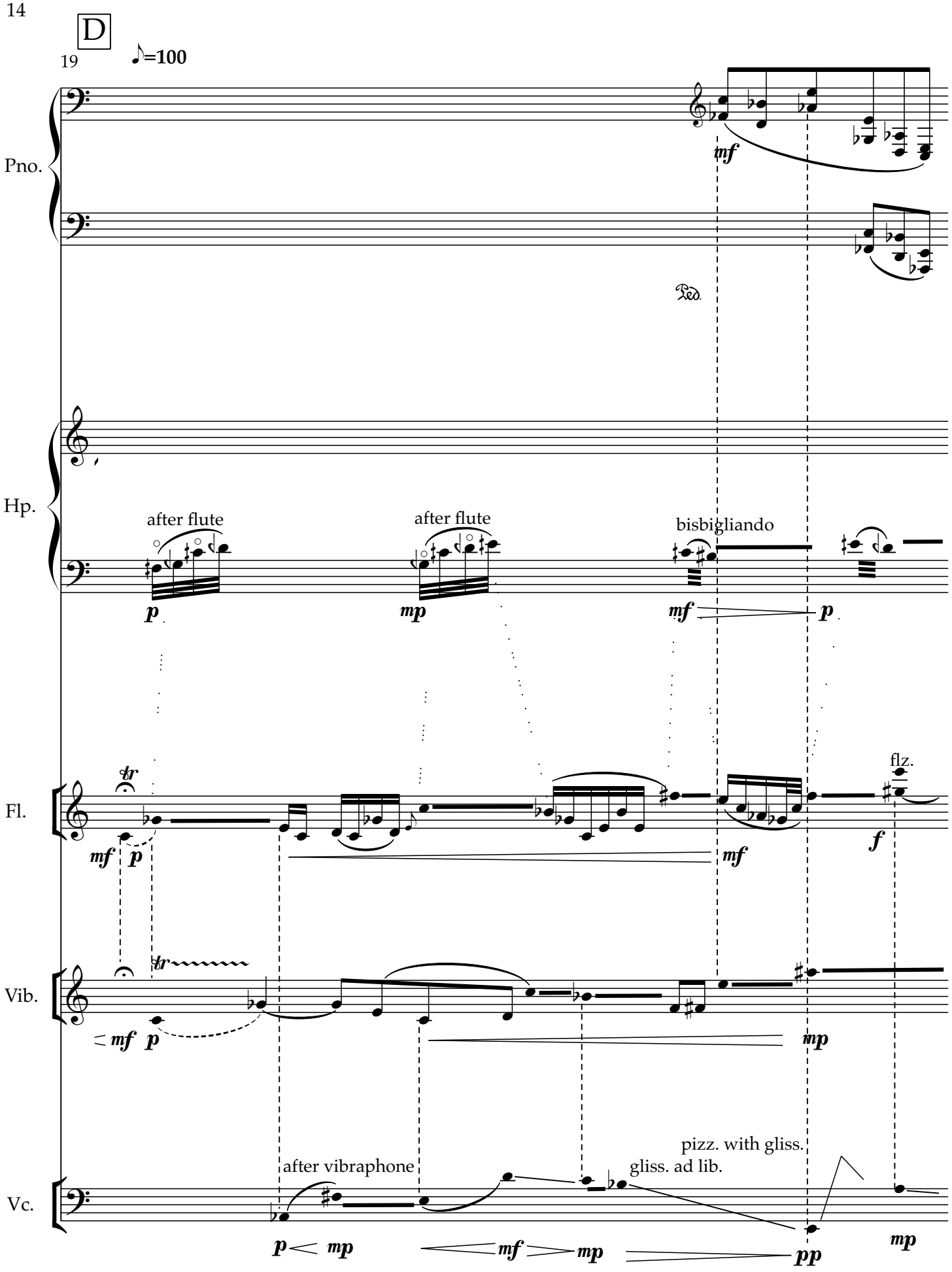

Pno.
mf
p
Ped.
R.H.
guqin
swish E
(ad lib.)
l.v.
Hp.
p
p
mf
ord.
Fl.
p
mp
mf
p
Vib.
mf
p
arco
sul ponticello
Vc.
n
mp
pp


slowly mix up order of notes
Pno.
mp
n
p
mf
p
mf
n
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Hp.
Fl.
Vib.
pp
sul ponticello
Vc.
pp


Pno.
l.v.
l.v.
pp
l.v
Ped.
Ped.
Hp.
pp
p
Fl.
p
n
Vib.
pp
pp
Vc.
pp


C
Pno.
mp
mf
mp
mf
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Hp.
bisbigliando
p
mf
Fl.
key clicks (wholetone scale ad lib.)
pp
mp
p
mf
Vib.
l.v.
l.v.
n
p
p
mp
pizz. with gliss.
arco
Vc.
pp
p
p
mp
p
pp
mf


18
Pno.
Hp.
Fl.
Vib.
Vc.
bisbigliando
gliss.


D
19
♪=100
Pno.
Ped.
Hp.
after flute
after flute
bisbigliando
Fl.
flz.
Vib.
Vc.
after vibraphone
gliss. ad lib.
pizz. with gliss.

♪=120

E

Pno.

ad lib. (sequence of single notes)

f *p* *p*

Hp.

bisbigliando ad lib.

f *p* *ppp*

Fl.

pitch bend ord. gliss.

slowly pitch bend ord. ad lib.

pitch bend

mf *mp* *f* *p*

Vib.

trem. ad lib.
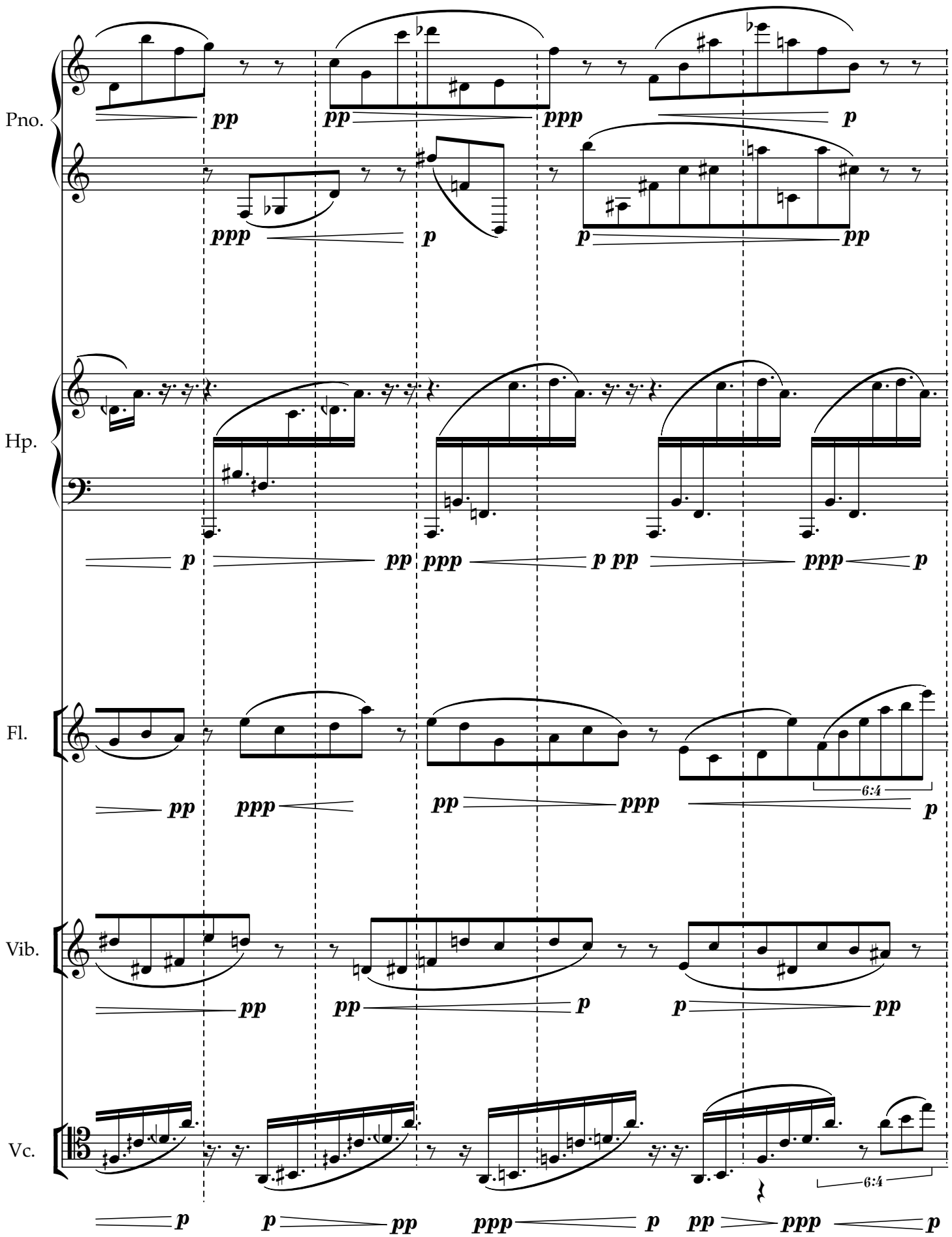
mf *f* *p*

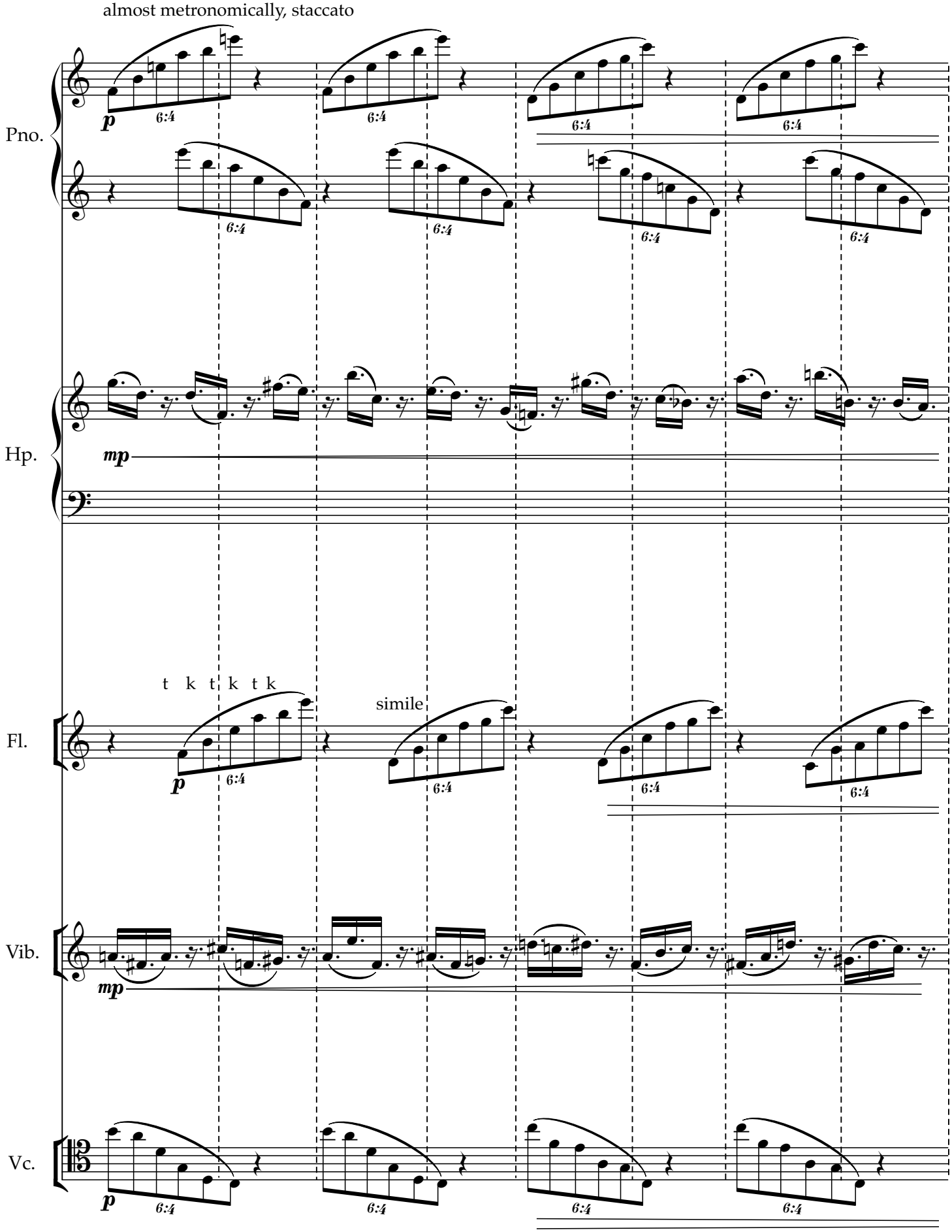
Vc.

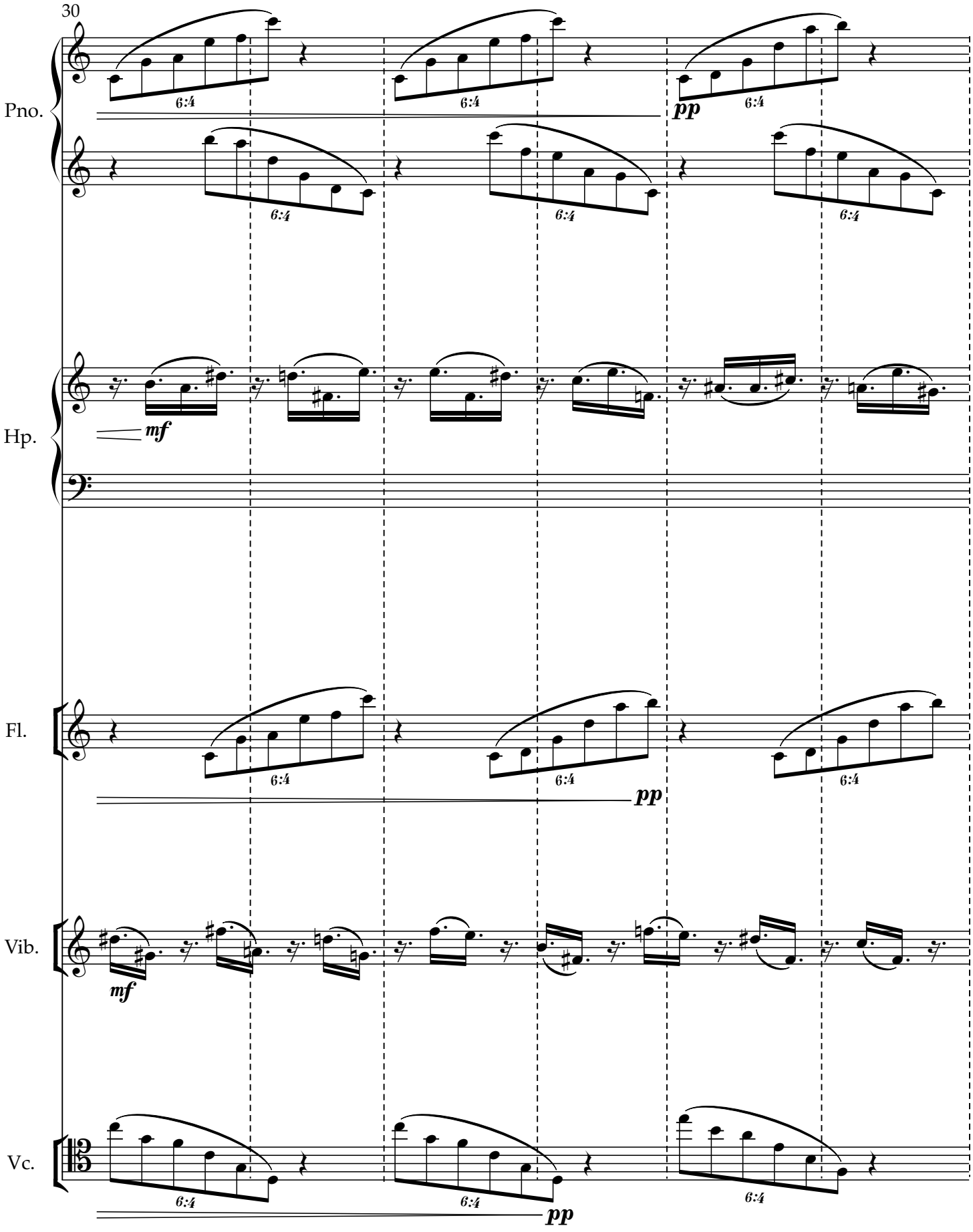
pizz with gliss. ad lib.

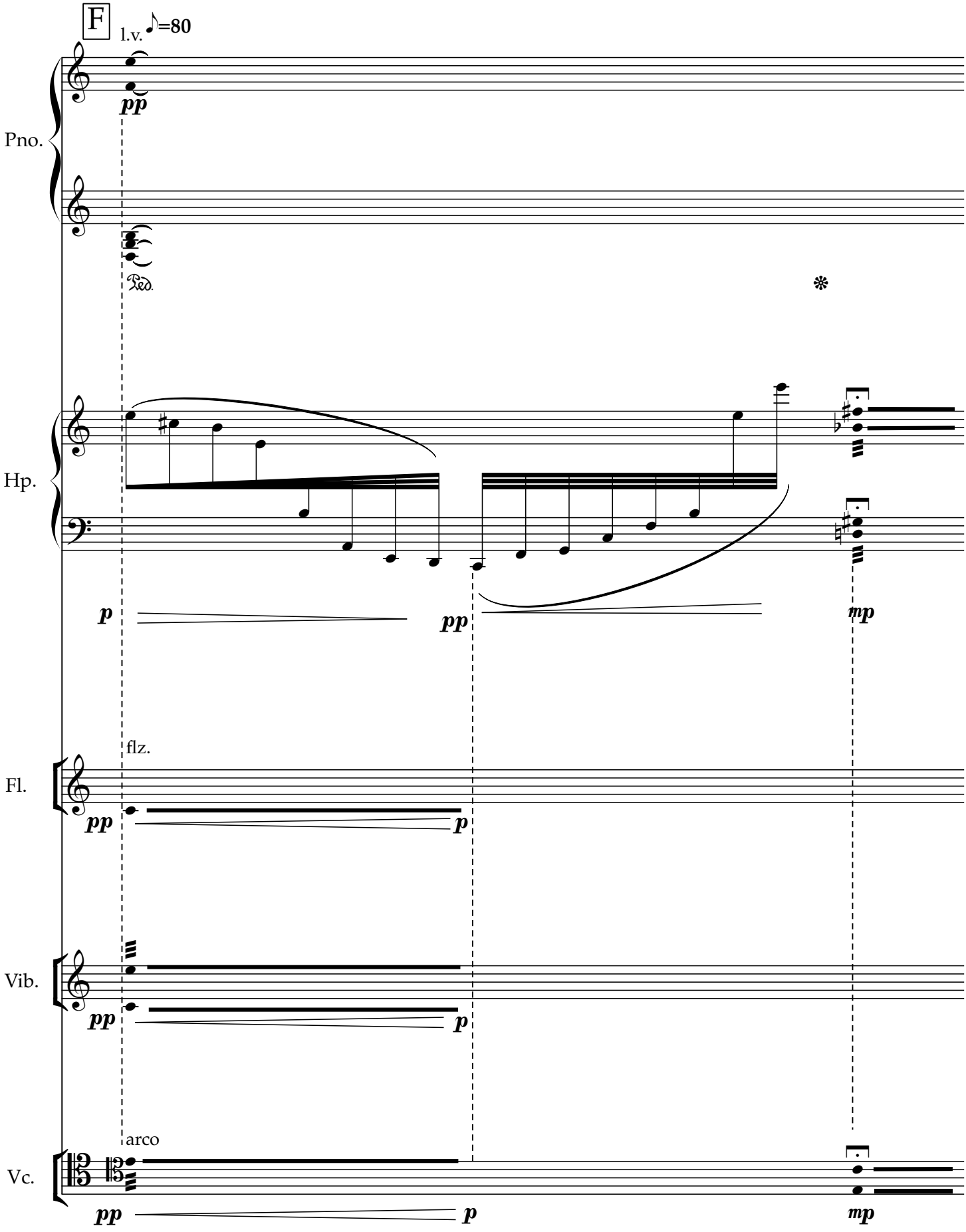
pizz.
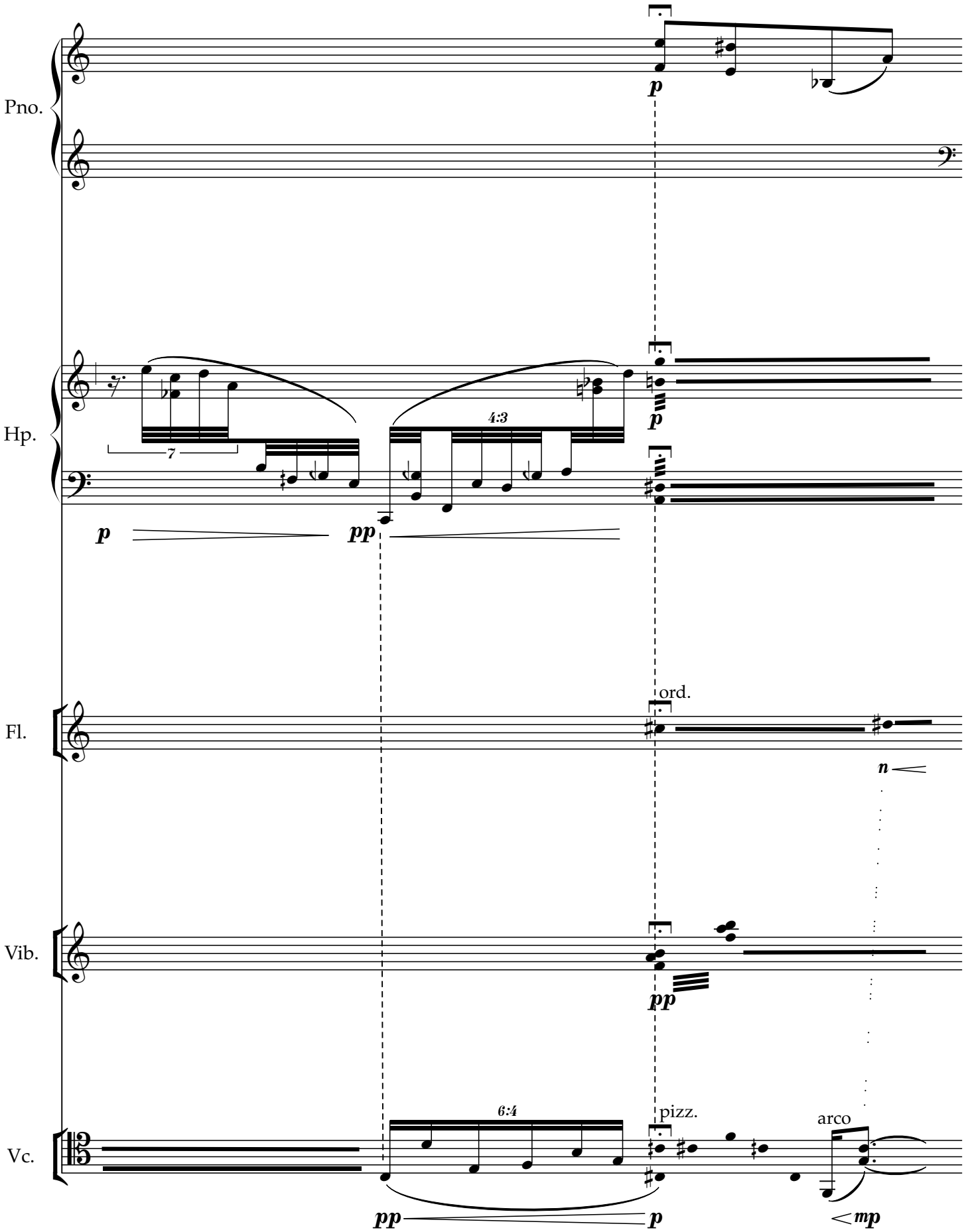
f *ppp*

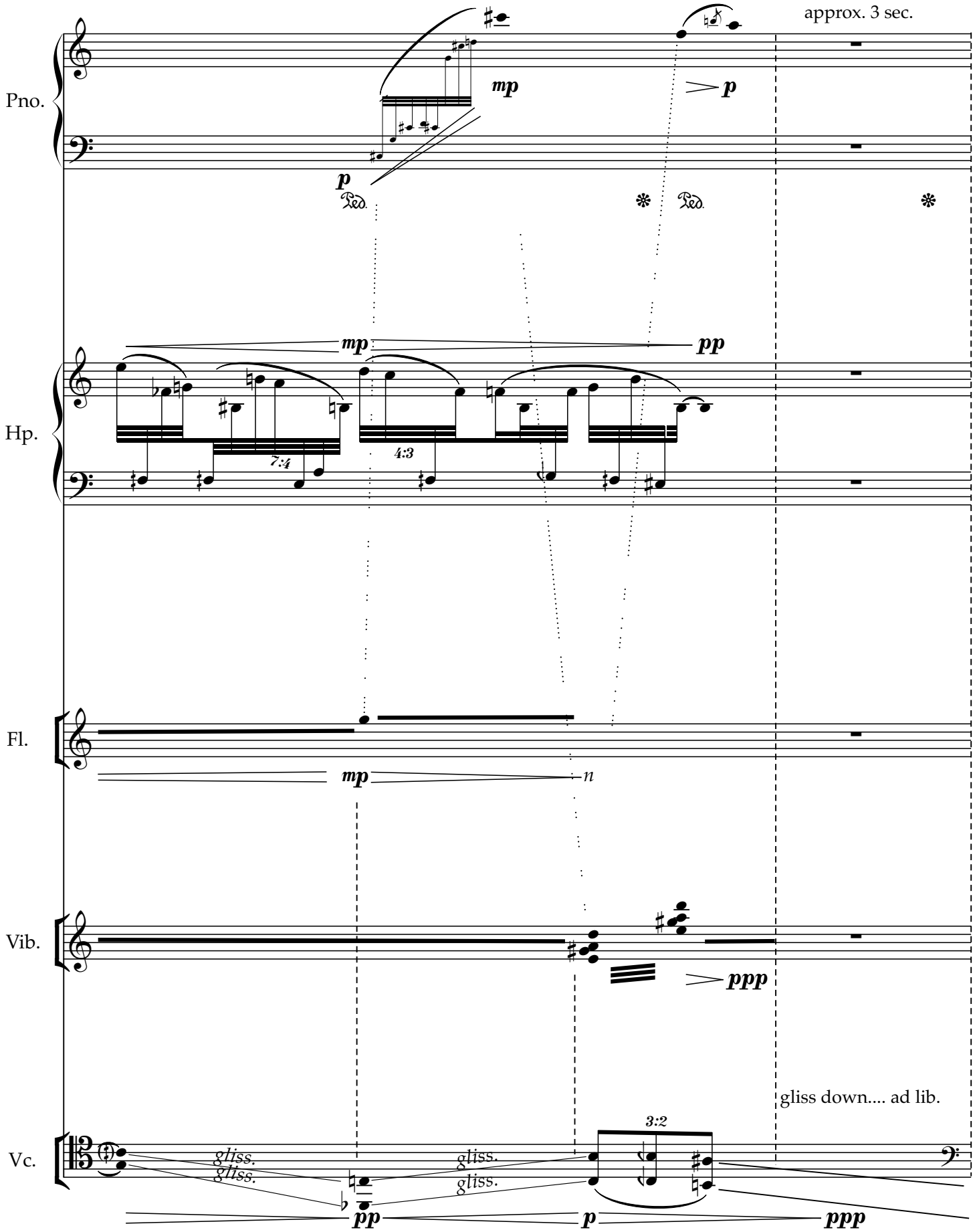

Pno.
pp
pp
ppp
p
ppp
p
p
pp
Hp.
p
pp
ppp
p pp
ppp
p
Fl.
pp
ppp
pp
ppp
6:4
p
Vib.
pp
pp
p
p
pp
Vc.
p
p
pp
ppp
p
pp
ppp
6:4
p
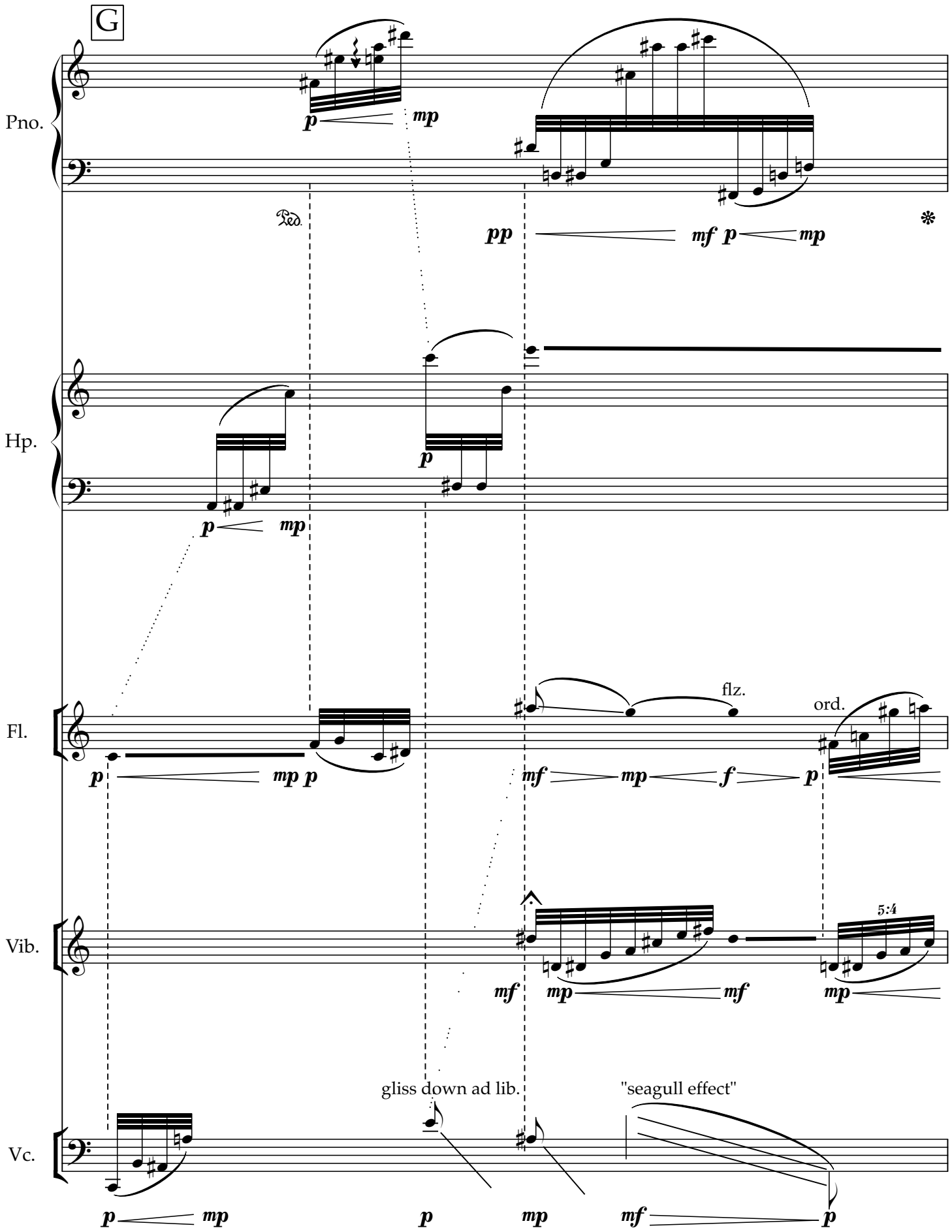

almost metronomically, staccato
Pno.
Hp.
Fl.
Vib.
Vc.
p
mp
6:4
t k t k t k
simile

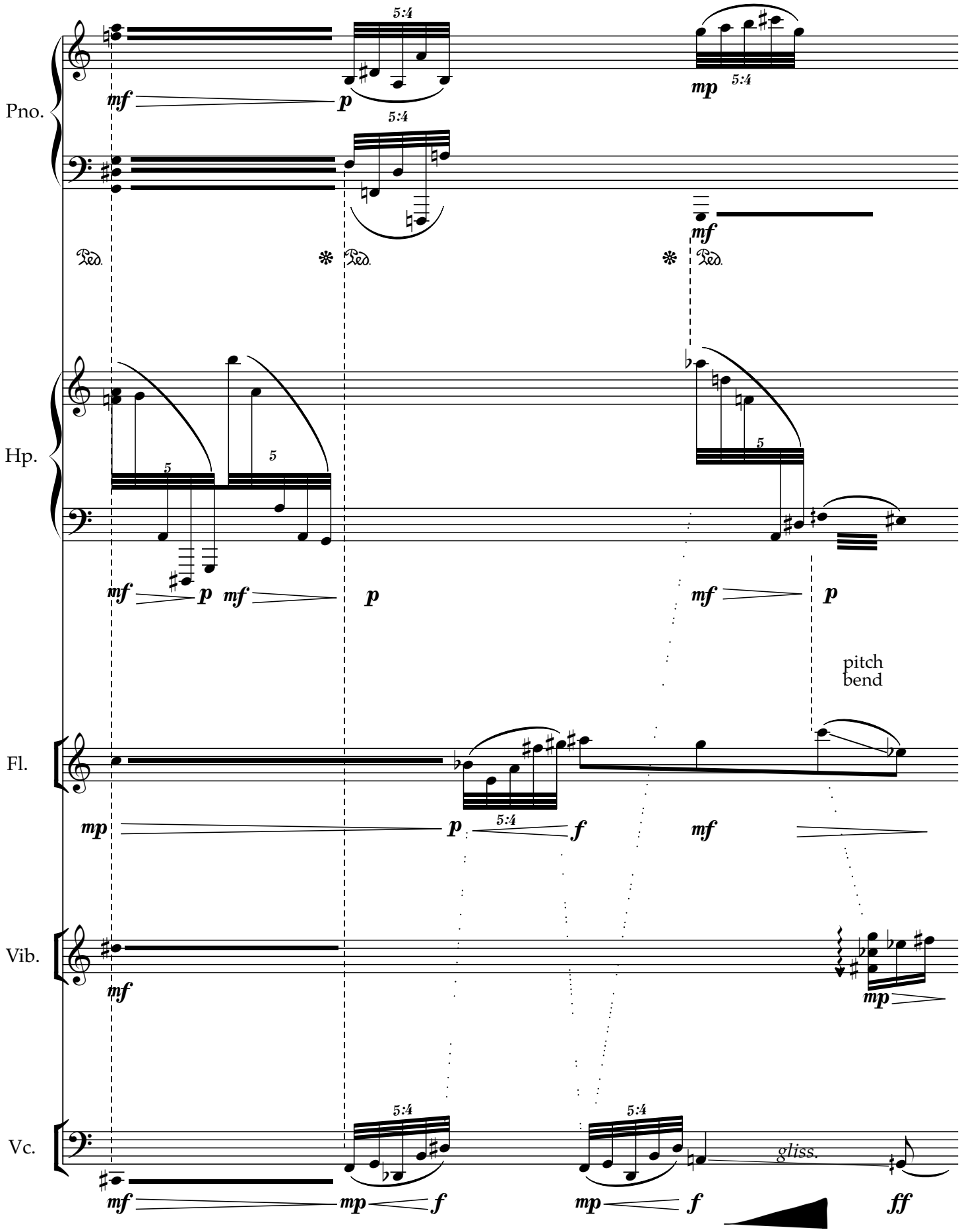

30
Pno.
6:4
6:4
pp
6:4
6:4
6:4
Hp.
mf
Fl.
6:4
6:4
pp
6:4
Vib.
mf
Vc.
6:4
6:4
pp
6:4

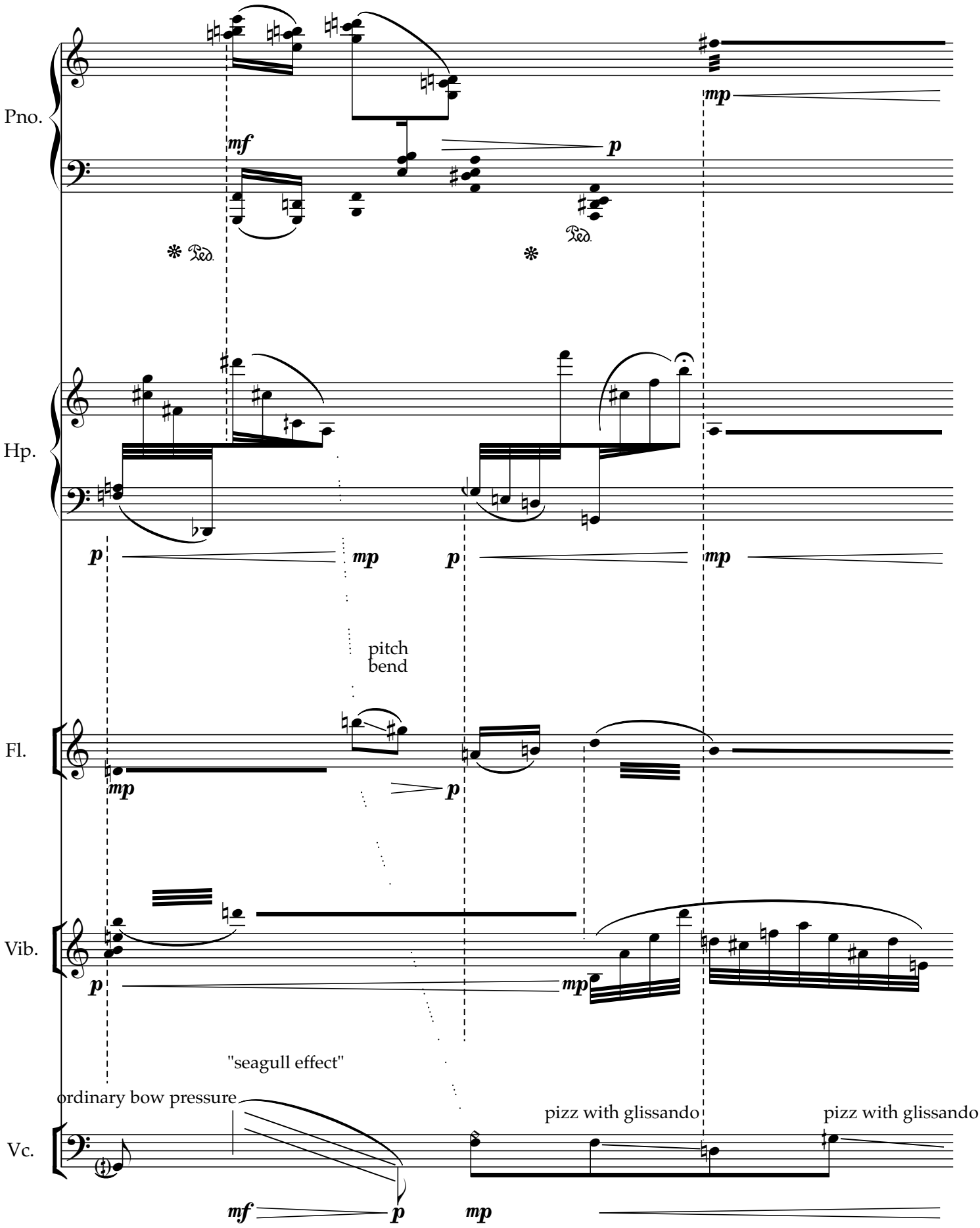

F
l.v.
♪=80
Pno.
pp
Ped.
*
Hp.
p
pp
mp
flz.
Fl.
pp
p
Vib.
pp
p
arco
Vc.
pp
p
mp
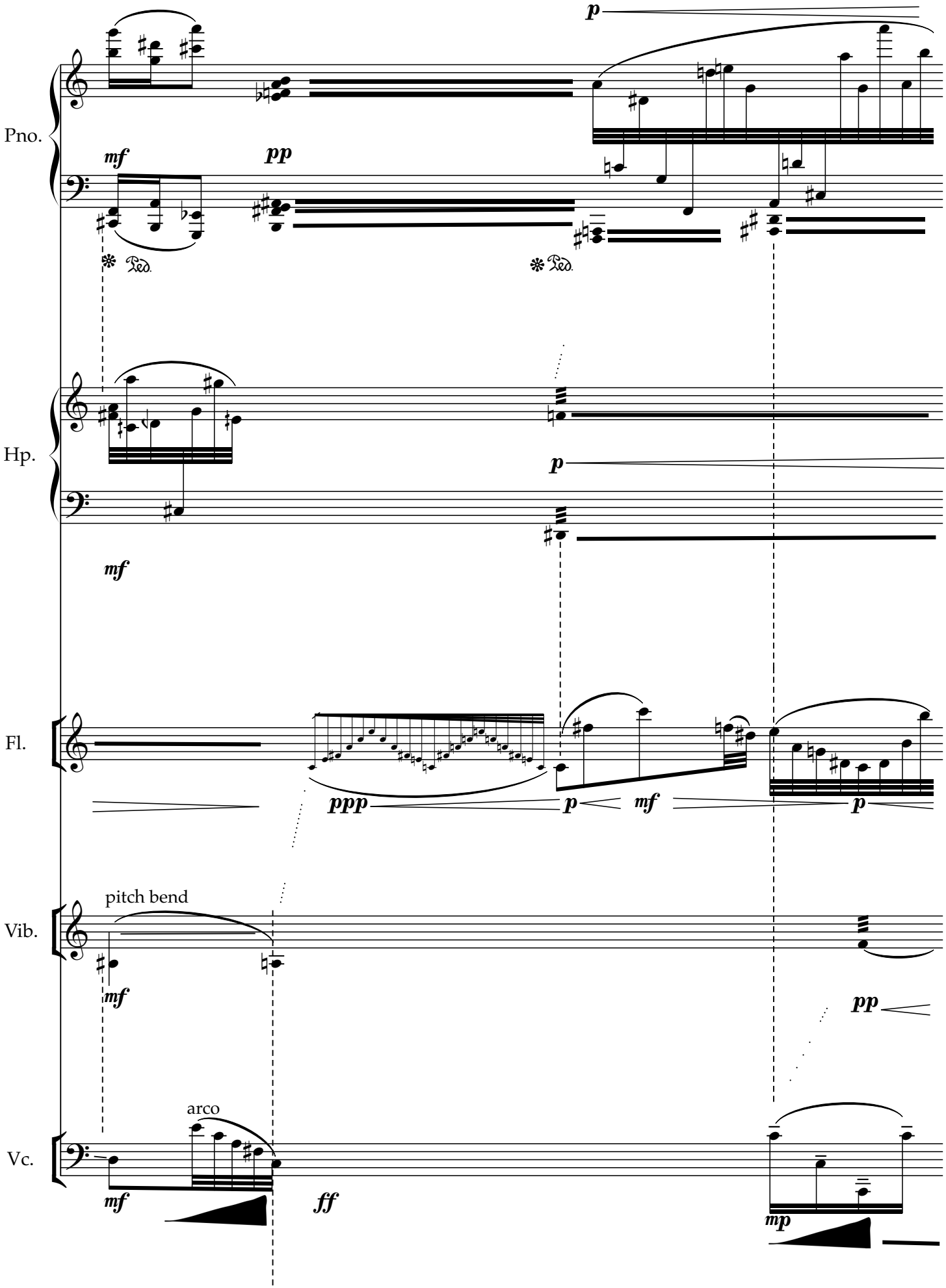

Pno.
Hp.
Fl.
Vib.
Vc.
p
7
4:3
pp
ord.
n
pp
6:4
pizz.
arco
pp
p
mp
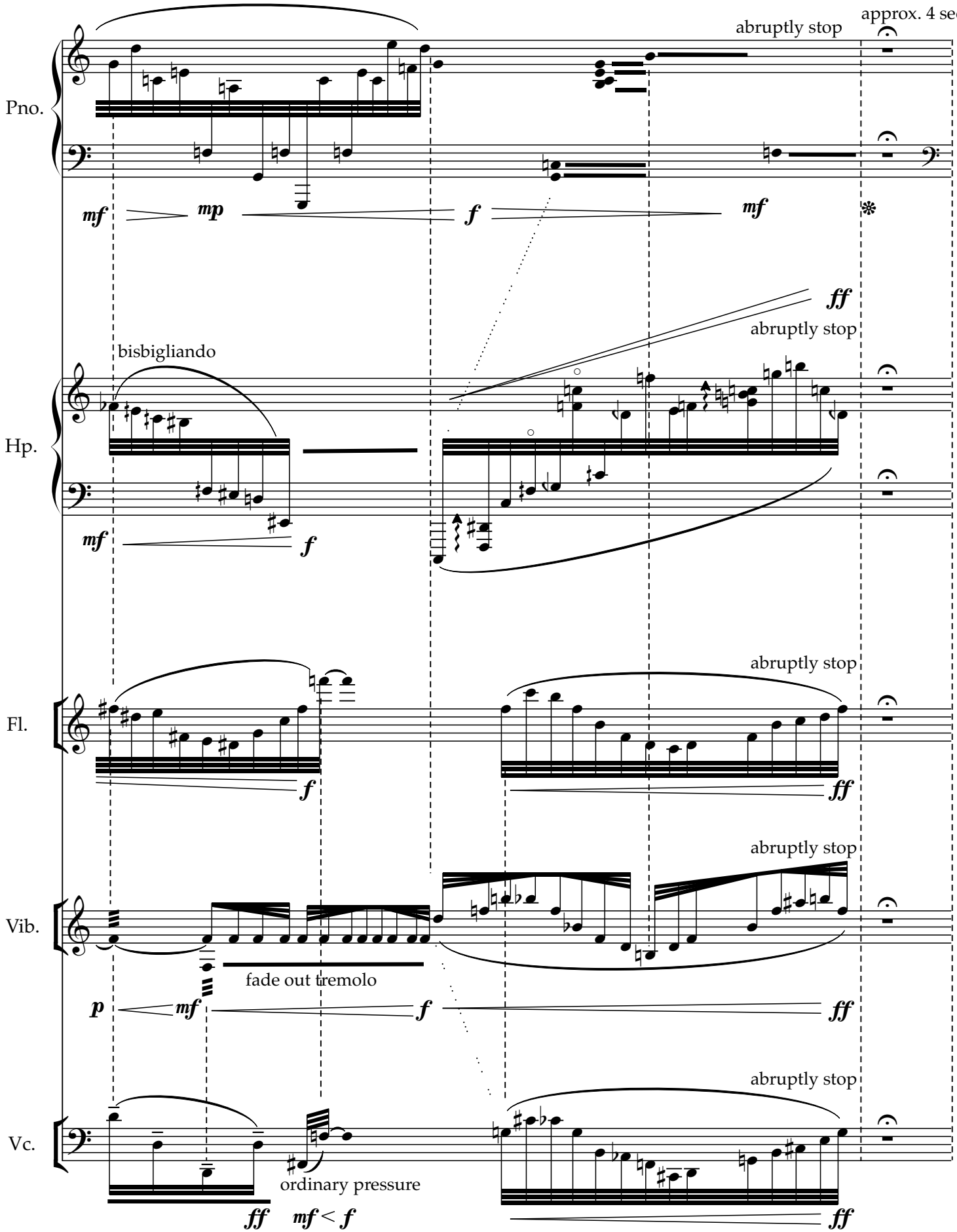

approx. 3 sec.
Pno.
mp
p
p
Ped.
Ped.
Hp.
mp
pp
7:4
4:3
Fl.
mp
n
Vib.
ppp
gliss down.... ad lib.
Vc.
3:2
gliss.
gliss.
gliss.
gliss.
pp
p
ppp

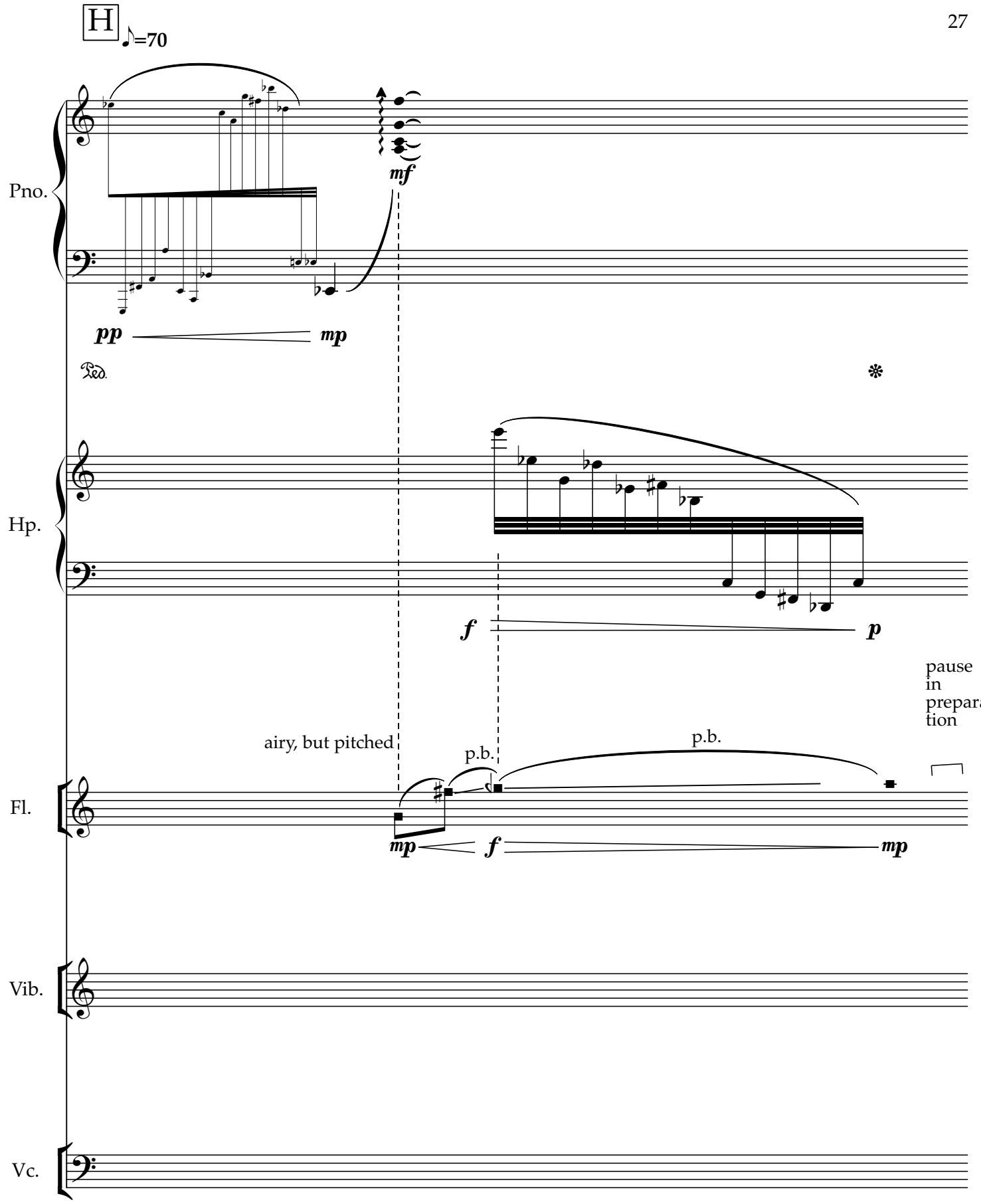

G
Pno.
Ped.
Hp.
Fl.
flz.
ord.
Vib.
5:4
gliss down ad lib.
"seagull effect"
Vc.
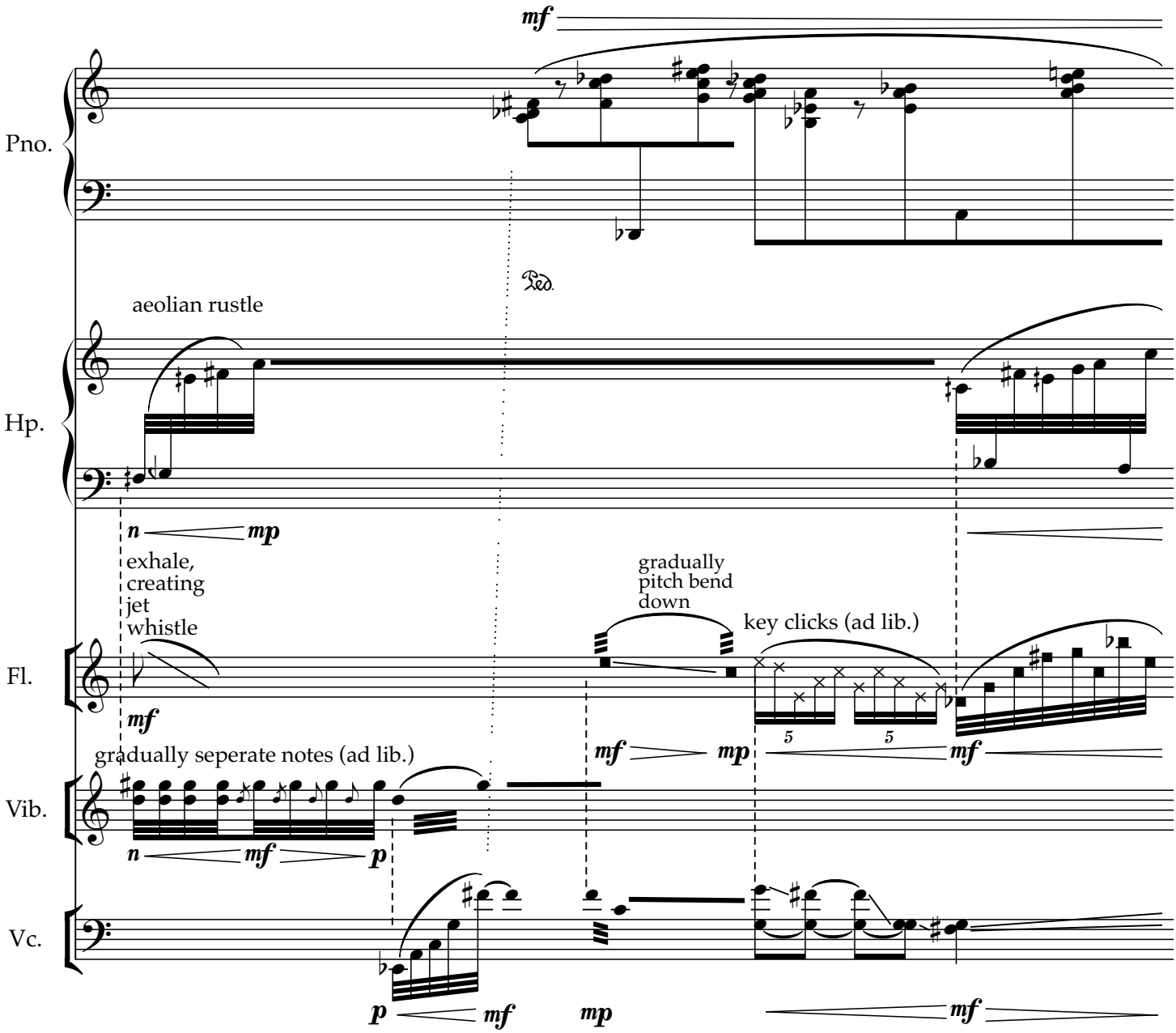

Pno.
Hp.
Fl.
Vib.
Vc.
pitch bend
gliss.
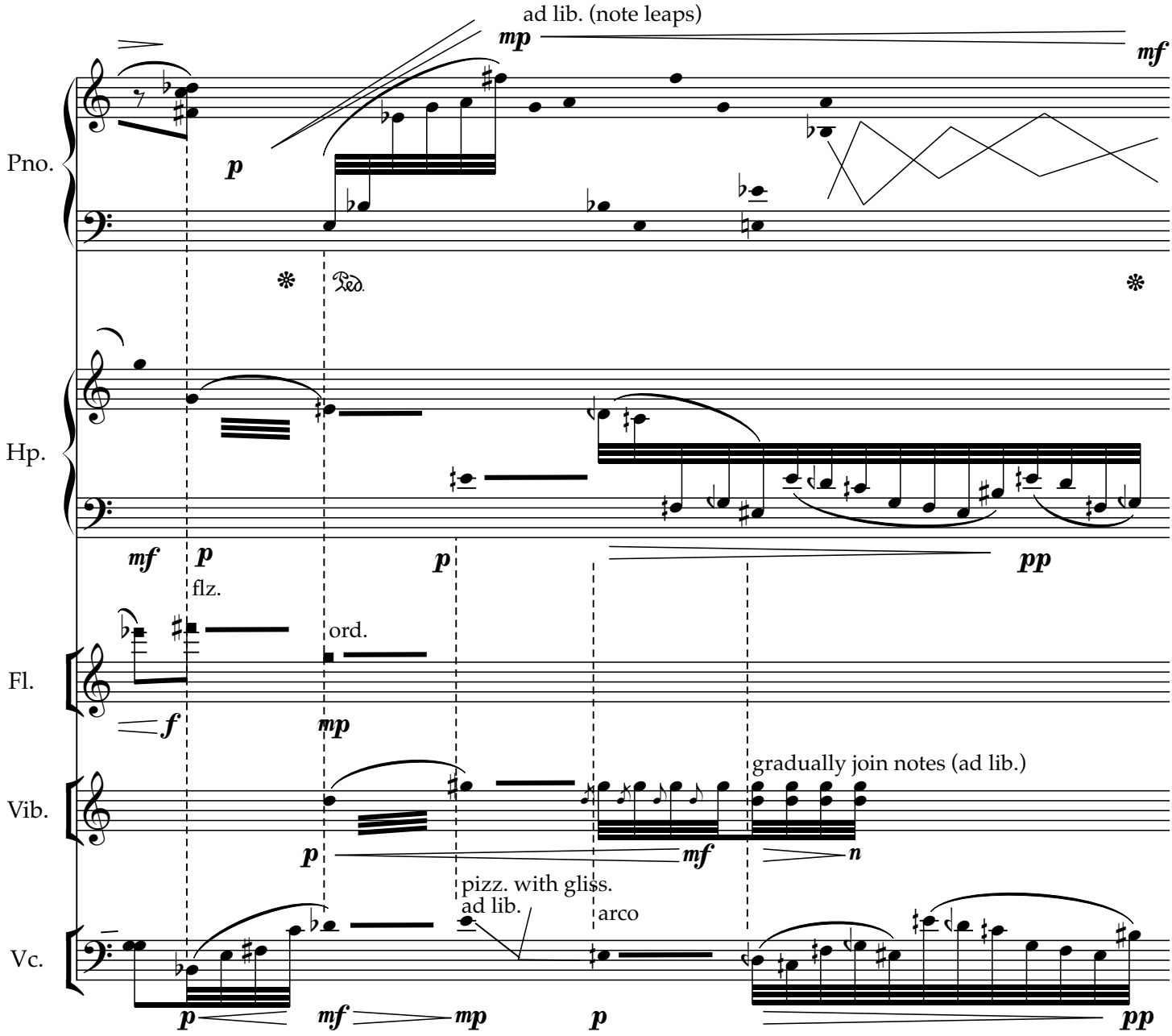

Pno.
mf
p
mp
Ped.
Hp.
p
mp
p
mp
pitch
bend
Fl.
mp
p
Vib.
p
mp
"seagull effect"
ordinary bow pressure
pizz with glissando
pizz with glissando
Vc.
mf
p
mp

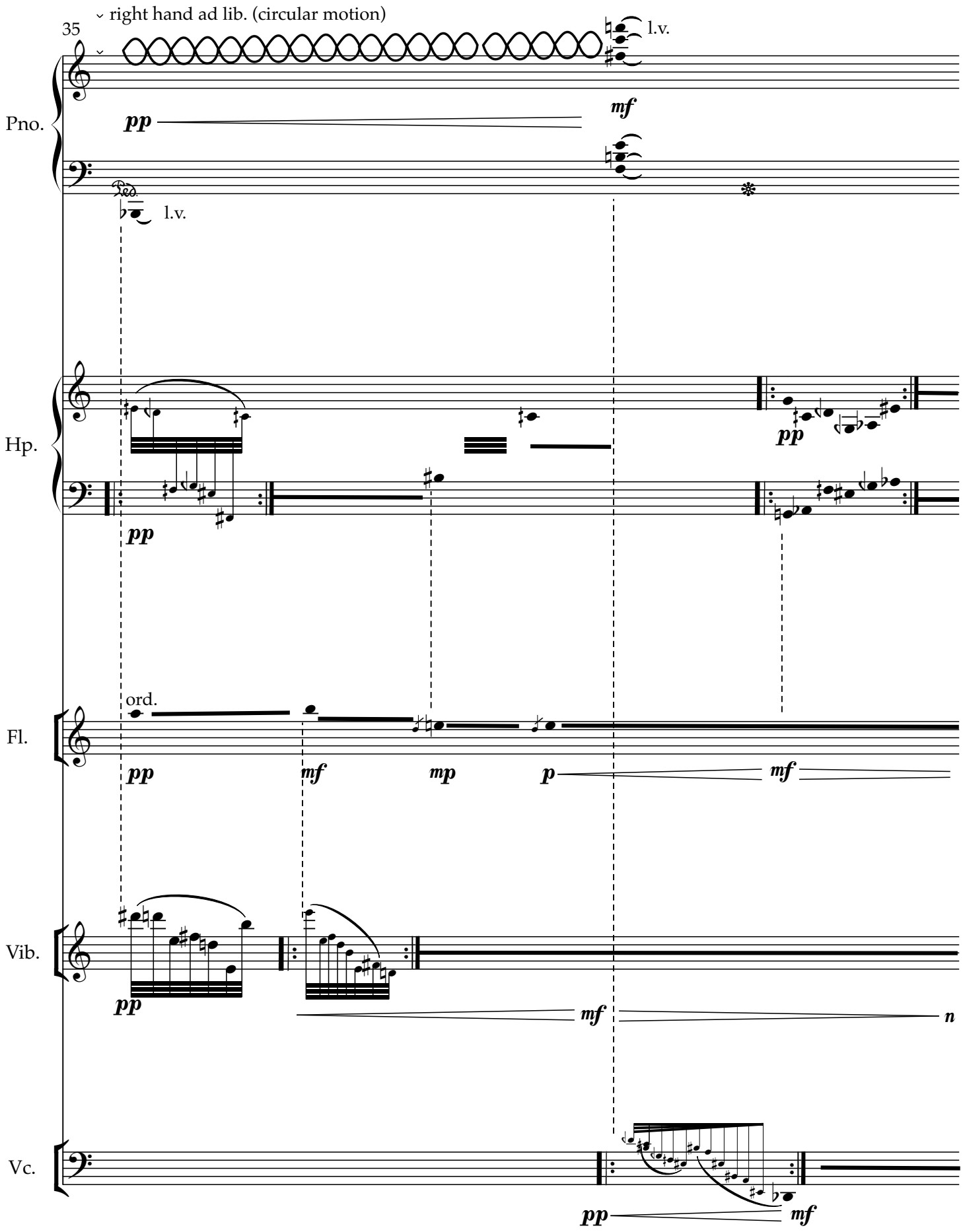

Pno.
Hp.
Fl.
Vib.
Vc.
p
mf
pp
Ped.
Ped.
p
mf
ppp
p
mf
p
pitch bend
mf
pp
arco
mf
ff
mp
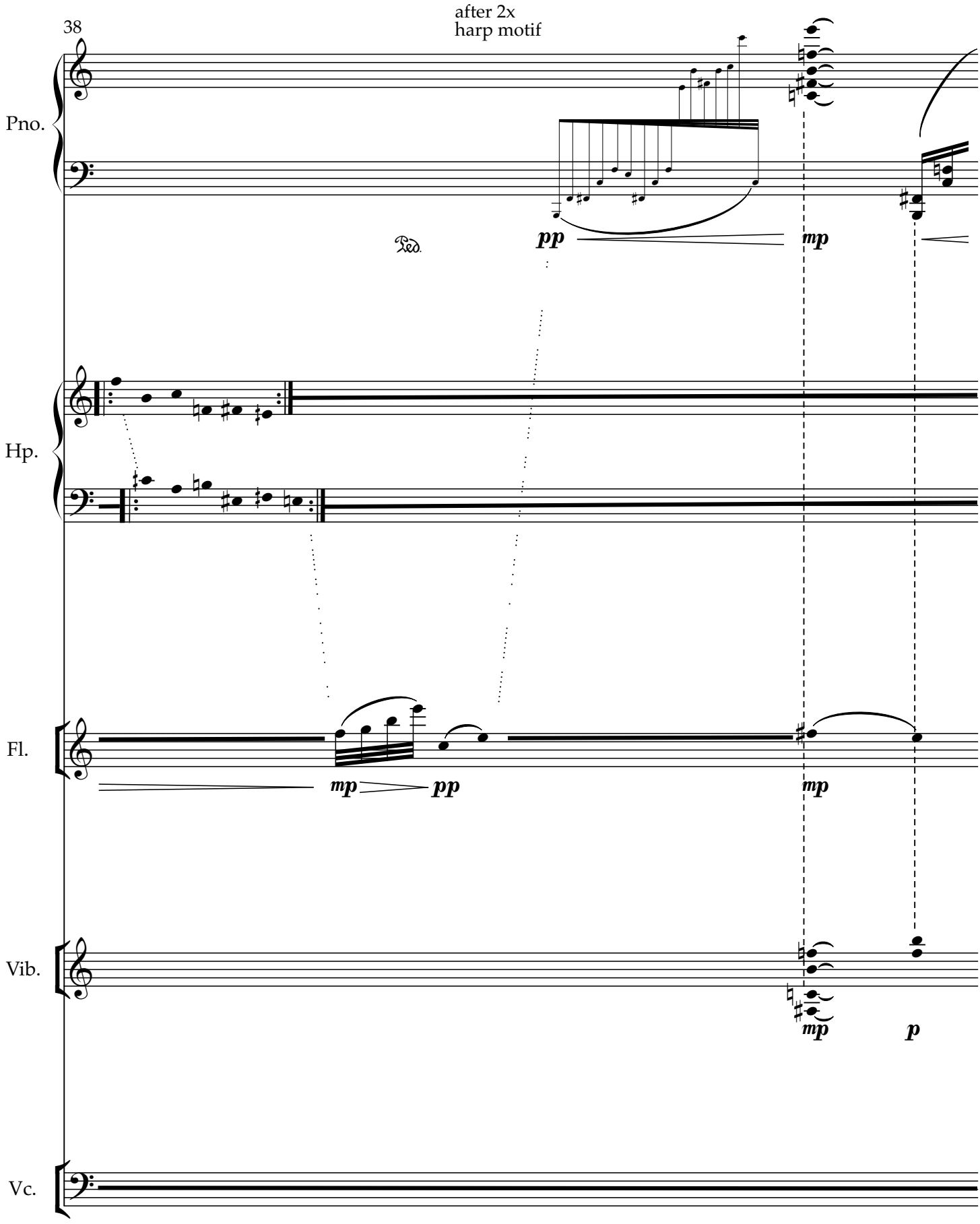

approx. 4 sec.
abruptly stop
Pno.
mf
mp
f
mf
ff
abruptly stop
bisbigliando
Hp.
mf
f
abruptly stop
Fl.
f
ff
abruptly stop
Vib.
fade out tremolo
p
mf
f
ff
abruptly stop
Vc.
ordinary pressure
ff
mf < f
ff
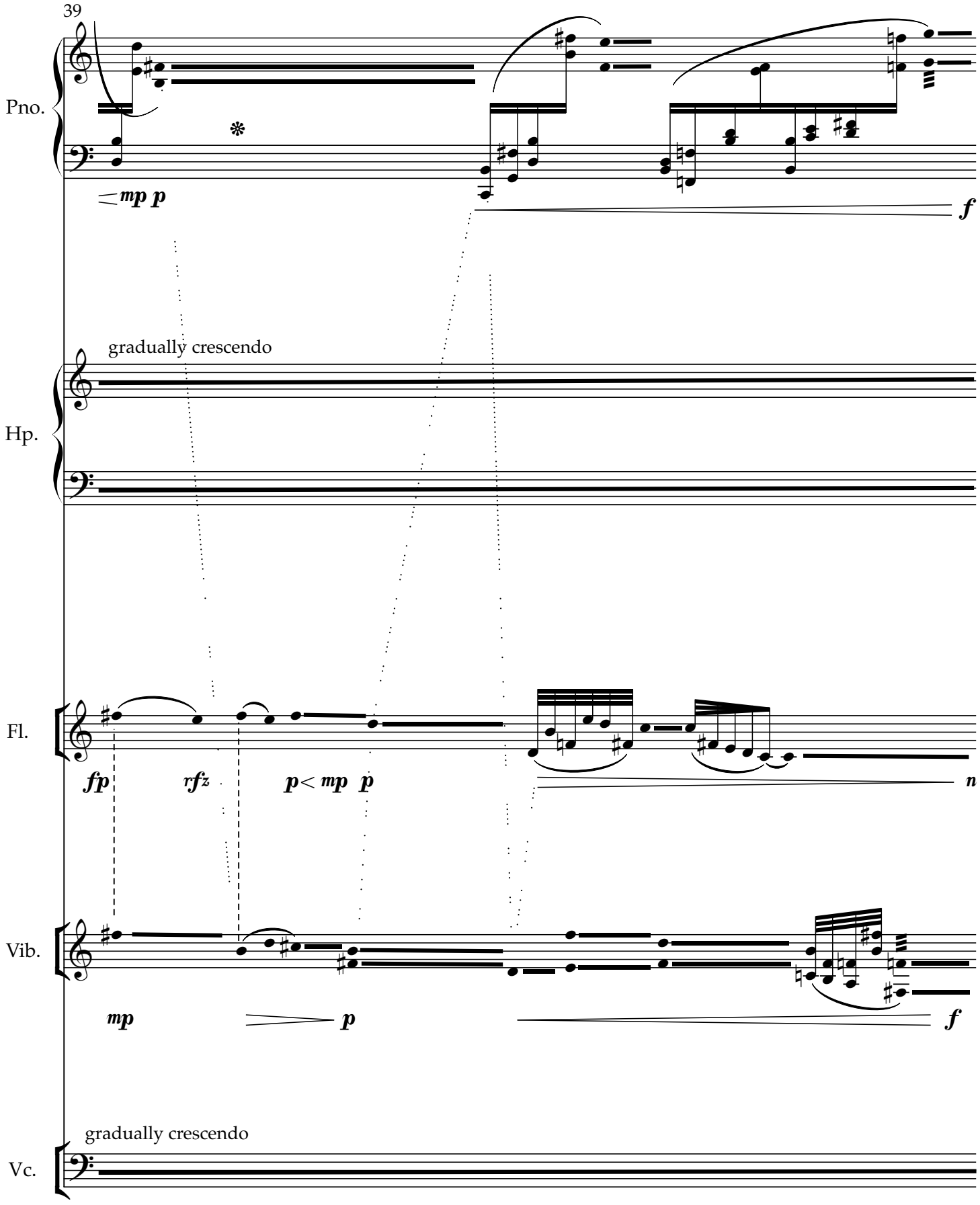

H
♪=70
Pno.
mf
pp
mp
Ped.
Hp.
f
p
pause in preparation
airy, but pitched
p.b.
p.b.
Fl.
mp
f
mp
Vib.
Vc.

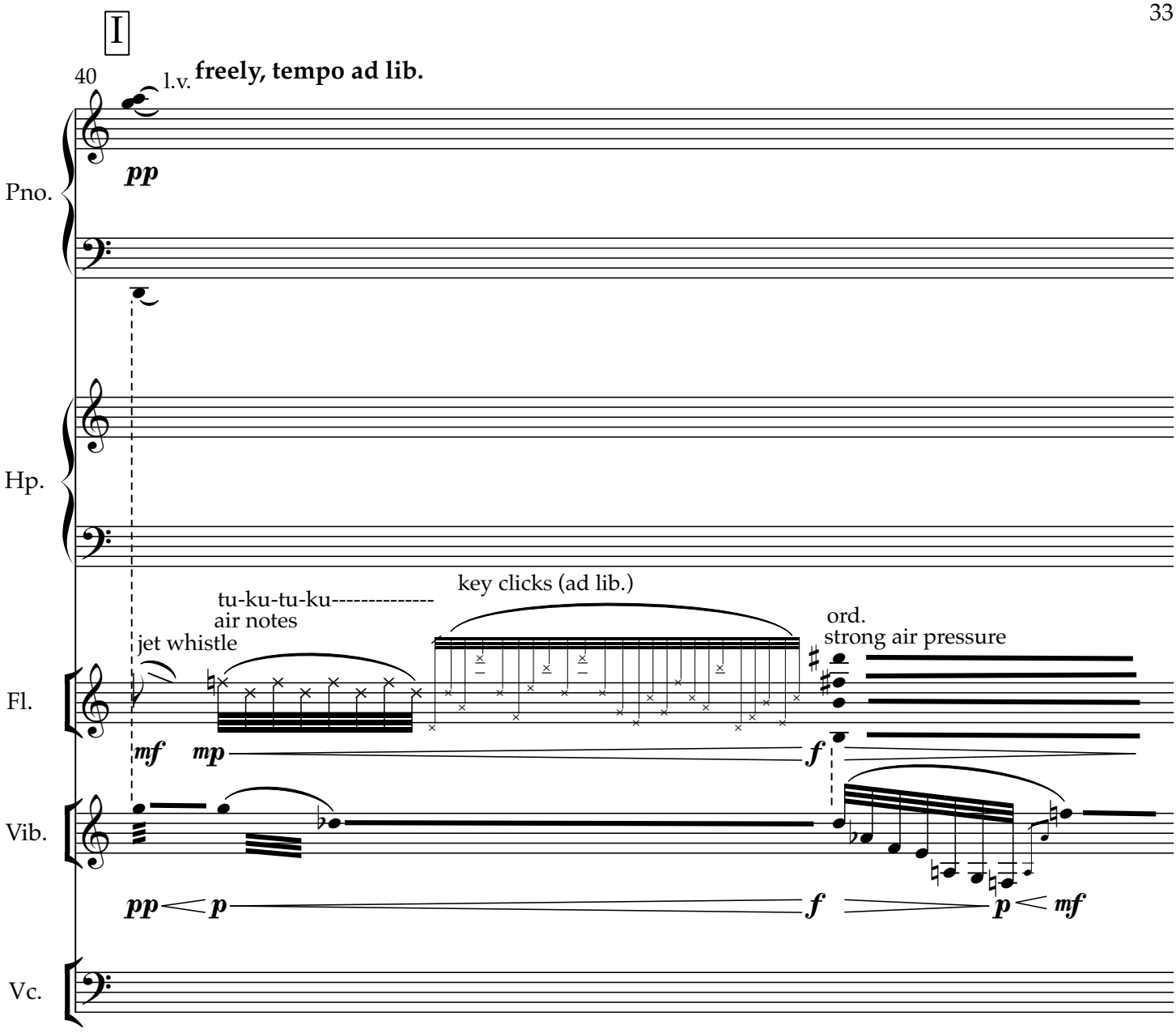

Pno.
mf
Ped.
Hp.
aeolian rustle
n
mp
Fl.
exhale,
creating
jet
whistle
mf
gradually
pitch bend
down
key clicks (ad lib.)
mf
mp
mf
Vib.
gradually seperate notes (ad lib.)
n
mf
p
Vc.
p
mf
mp
mf

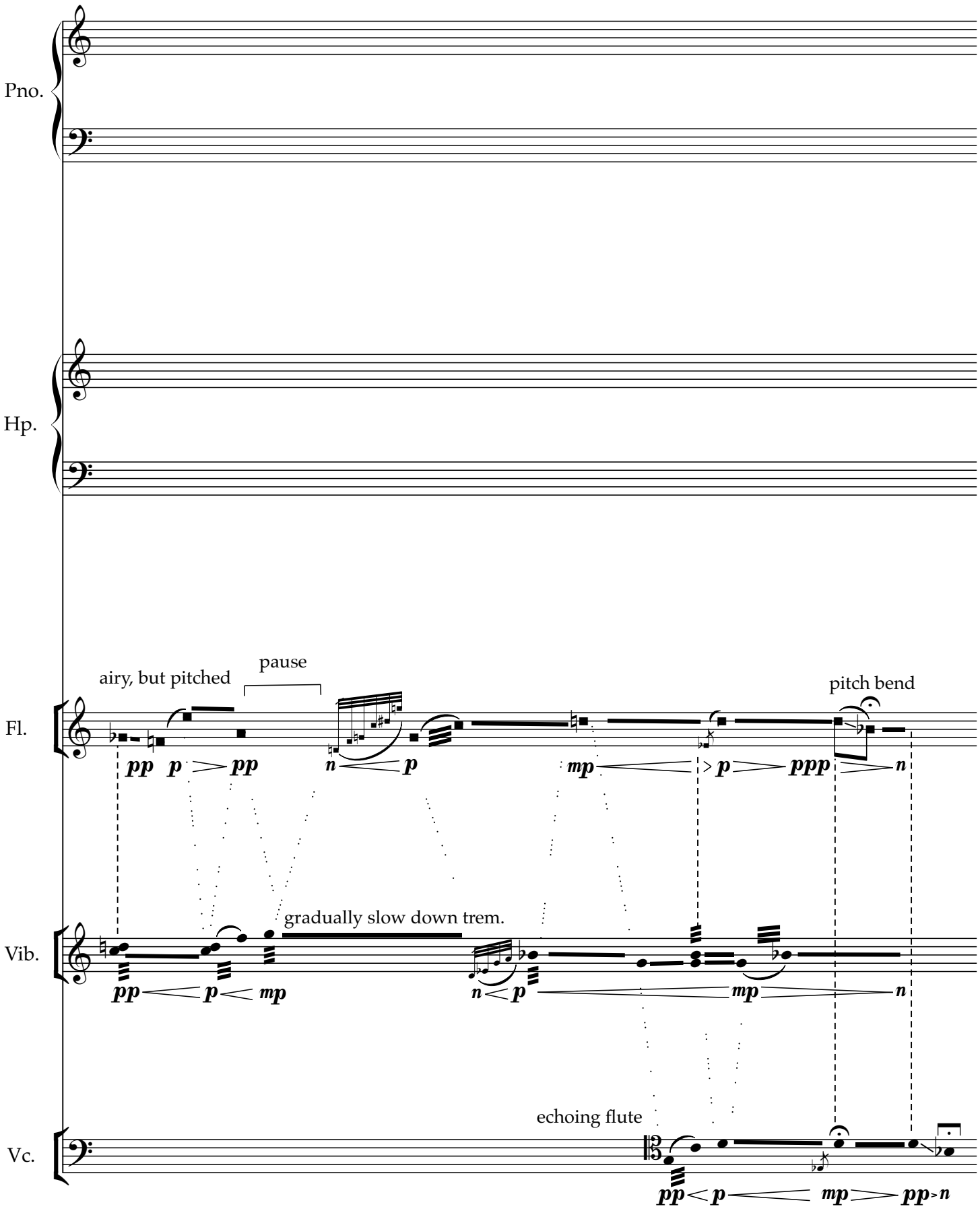

ad lib. (note leaps)
mp
mf
Pno.
p
Ped.
Hp.
mf
p
p
pp
flz.
ord.
Fl.
f
mp
gradually join notes (ad lib.)
Vib.
p
mf
n
pizz. with gliss.
ad lib.
arco
Vc.
p
mf
mp
p
pp

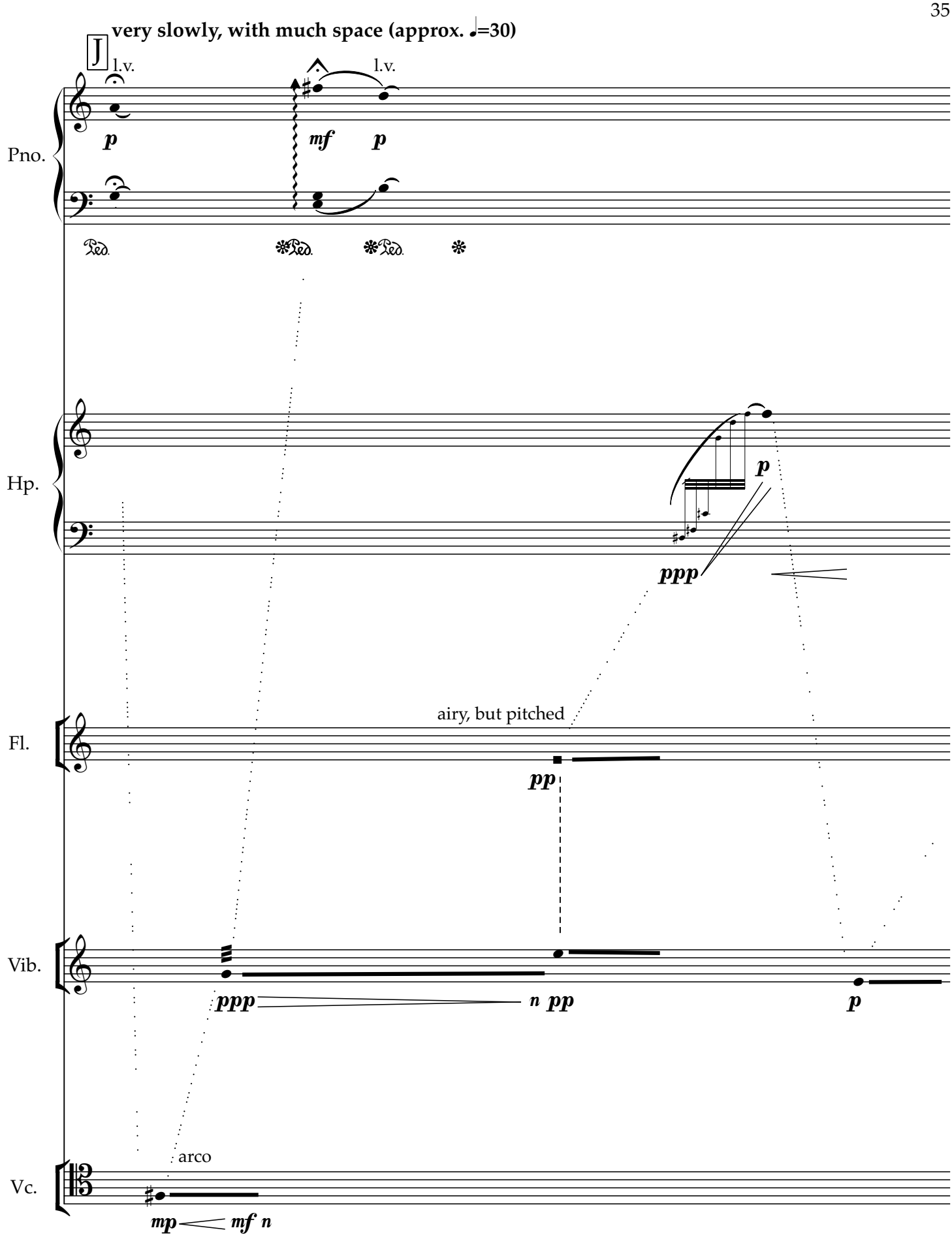

35
right hand ad lib. (circular motion)
l.v.
Pno.
pp
mf
Ped.
l.v.
Hp.
pp
pp
Fl.
ord.
pp
mf
mp
p
mf
Vib.
pp
mf
n
Vc.
pp
mf

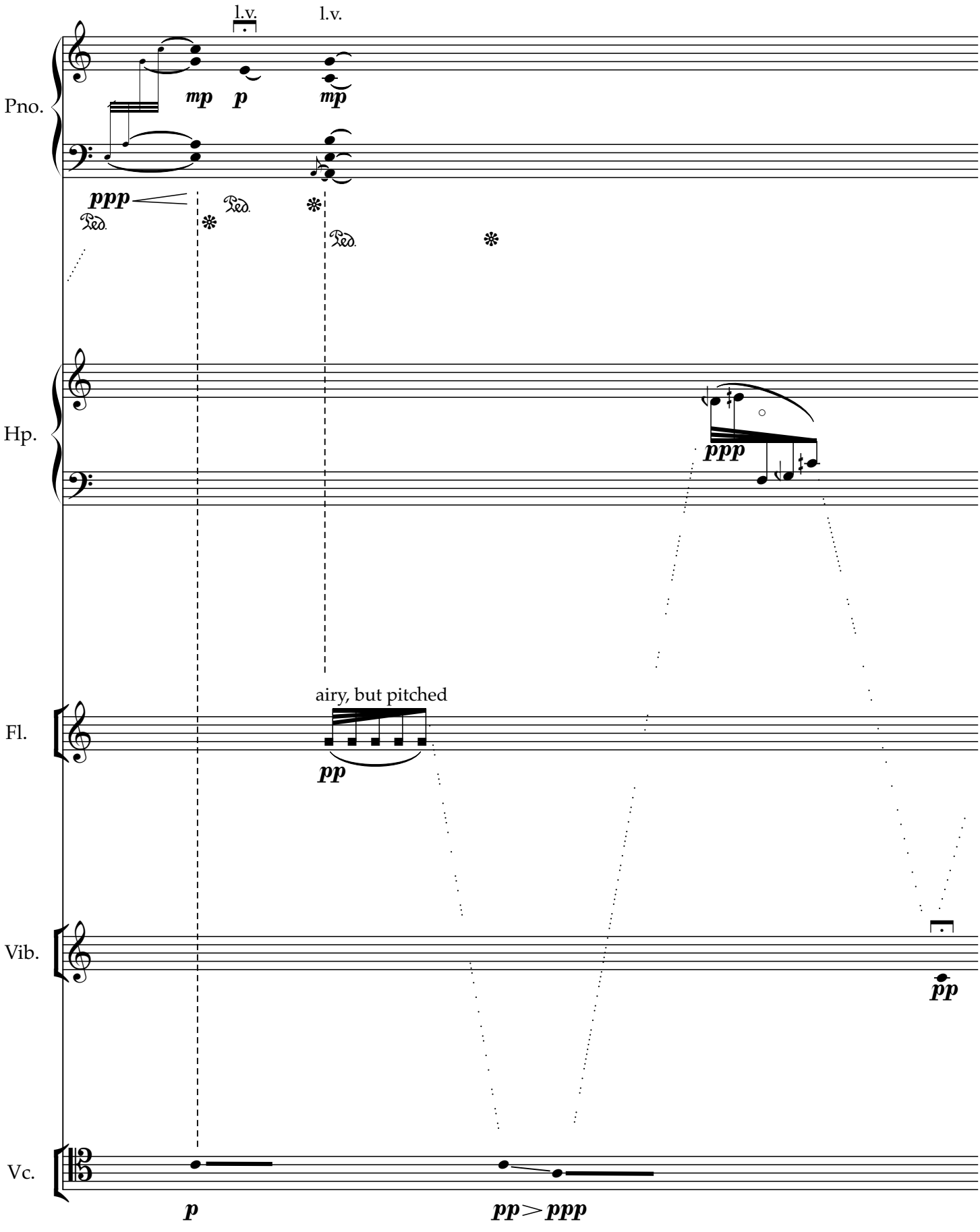

38
after 2x
harp motif
Pno.
Ped.
pp
mp
Hp.
Fl.
mp
pp
mp
Vib.
mp
p
Vc.

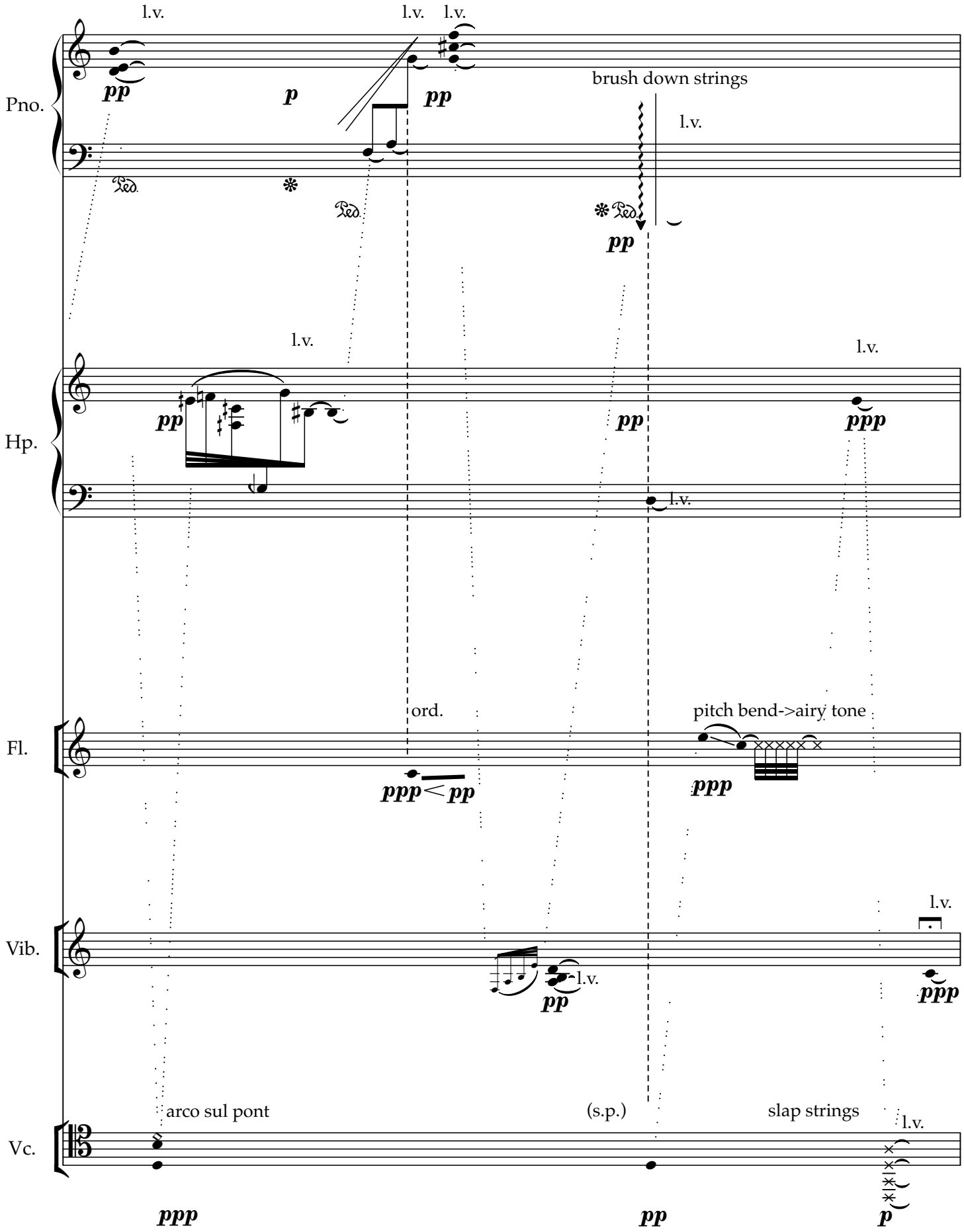

39
Pno.
mp p
f
gradually crescendo
Hp.
Fl.
fp
rfz
p< mp p
n
Vib.
mp
p
f
gradually crescendo
Vc.

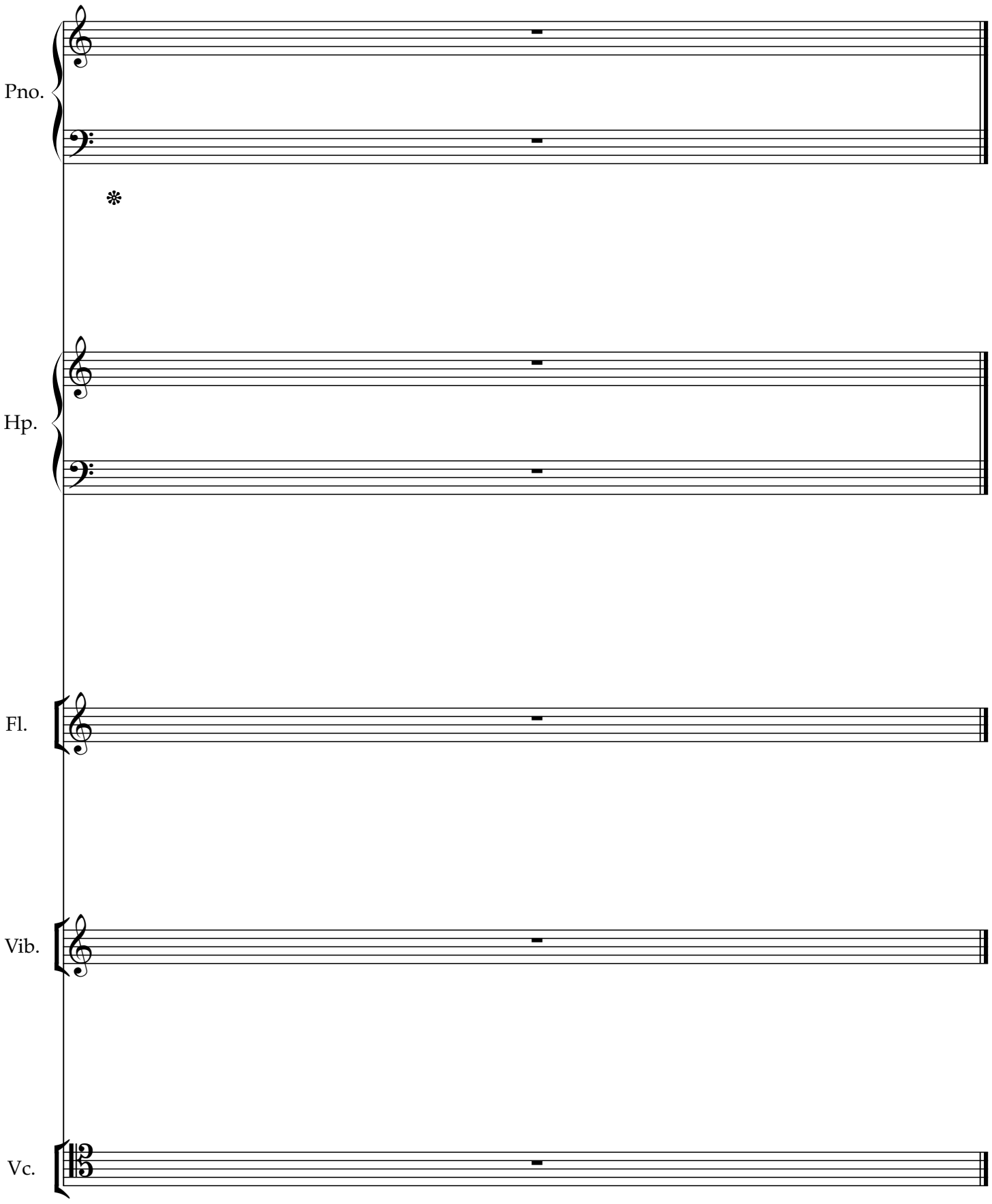

I
40
l.v.
freely, tempo ad lib.
Pno.
pp
Hp.
Fl.
jet whistle
tu-ku-tu-ku----------
air notes
key clicks (ad lib.)
ord.
strong air pressure
mf
mp
f
Vib.
pp
p
f
p
mf
Vc.


Pno.
Hp.
Fl.
airy, but pitched
pause
pitch bend
pp p pp n p mp p ppp n
Vib.
gradually slow down trem.
pp p mp n p mp n
Vc.
echoing flute
pp p mp pp n


very slowly, with much space (approx. ♩=30)
J
l.v.
l.v.
Pno.
p
mf
p
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Hp.
p
ppp
Fl.
airy, but pitched
pp
Vib.
ppp
n pp
p
Vc.
arco
mp
mf n


l.v.
l.v.
Pno.
mp
p
mp
ppp
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.
Hp.
ppp
airy, but pitched
Fl.
pp
Vib.
pp
Vc.
p
pp > ppp


Pno.
l.v.
l.v.
l.v.
pp
p
pp
brush down strings
l.v.
pp
Hp.
l.v.
l.v.
pp
pp
ppp
l.v.
Fl.
ord.
pitch bend->airy tone
ppp < pp
ppp
Vib.
l.v.
l.v.
pp
ppp
Vc.
arco sul pont
(s.p.)
slap strings
l.v.
ppp
pp
p


Pno.
Hp.
Fl.
Vib.
Vc.